

What Is This?

This book is an adventure module for *Materia Mundi*. Before you read further, you should read the *Materia Mundi Player's Guide*, then decide whether you want to be a player or the referee. If you want to be a player, you should probably stop reading this book, find your referee, and give it to them so that you can enjoy the surprises hidden in its pages.

If you want to be the referee, you should also read the *Materia Mundi Referee's Guide* and *Materia Mundi: History*, and make sure that you're familiar enough with both before continuing with this adventure. It's a good idea to keep the *Referee's Guide*, *History*, and *Panoply* books on-hand as you read this book, and reference them whenever you need to.

Adventuring in Materia Mundi

Materia Mundi is a roleplaying system in the old-school tradition. If you're familiar with "B/X" or derived rule systems, everything here should be somewhat familiar to you. That said, there are a few differences between the original "Basic/Expert" rules and setting, and those of *Materia Mundi*.

Saving Throws

Creatures in *Materia Mundi* all share a unified d20 saving throw and attack throw mechanic, which is slightly different from the class-and-level based saving throws in B/X. A saving throw is made by rolling a d20 and comparing it to a *threshold*, which is the number you need to match or beat on the d20 to successfully save vs. a threat of that nature. There are six types of saving throw in *Materia Mundi*, each based on a different ability modifier:

- Constitution** – save vs. Doom / Death
- Strength** – save vs. Hold / Paralysis
- Dexterity** – save vs. Blast / Ray
- Intelligence** – save vs. Trick / Illusion
- Wisdom** – save vs. Curse / Spell
- Charisma** – save vs. Fear / Panic

Each saving throw threshold depends on the sum of the creature's ability modifier + class level or hit dice:

-2	-1	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10+
17+	16+	15+	14+	13+	12+	11+	10+	9+	8+	7+	6+	5+

Attack Throws

A creature's attack throws are also based on this formula, so a creature's melee attack throw threshold is the same as their Strength saving throw threshold, while their ranged attack throw threshold equals their Dexterity saving throw threshold. There is no "Armor Class" in *Materia Mundi*; armor here reduces damage, rather than making attacks more difficult to land.

Skills

Creatures in *Materia Mundi* also have skills, which are more focused areas of expertise. Skills are always rolled using a d6; if the d6 matches or beats the skill threshold, the attempt is a success.

NPCs and Monsters

Each monster or NPC listed in this setting will have a "stat block" that lists their ability modifiers, with that ability's saving throw threshold in parentheses after the ability modifier, so you don't have to compute them yourself. Alongside its abilities will be the monster's hit dice, hit points, and defense.

Below it will be a single attack threshold and skill threshold, along with each attack or skill that it can use at that level. If a monster needs to roll a skill that it doesn't have, the referee can either decide that it can't succeed at that attempt, or give it a 1-in-6 chance of success. Any unusual senses or feats that the monster has will be mentioned next.

Magic and Treasure

All magic items in *Materia Mundi* are one of four rarity levels: common (usually with a +1 bonus), uncommon (+2), rare (+3), or legendary (+4). Spells and miracles and other magical effects, likewise, have three different power levels, called circles. First-circle magics are the easiest, and usually correspond to the power level of a common magic item; second-circle magics are more powerful, matching the effects of an uncommon magic item, and can usually only be performed by a fifth-level magic-user. The most complex and powerful third-circle magics duplicate the effects of rare magic items, and can only be performed by a ninth-level magic-user. There is no circle of magic available to mortals that corresponds to the power level of a legendary magic item.

Arriving in the Pale

The Pale Keep is intended to be run as an introductory adventure for characters level 1-3. It serves to introduce a small corner of the world, a wild land half-claimed by faerie called the Isle of Mists, which the kingdom of Albion is trying unsuccessfully to conquer and subjugate.

On Money — the coins of the realm in Albion are the gold drakhma or drac, the silver dinarus or dime, and the copper penny. One dime is worth roughly one day's wages for an unskilled laborer; one drac is worth ten dimes, and one dime is worth ten pennies. Dwarven currency is less common, but still recognized — the electrum quarter is worth 25 pennies, and the nickel (made, unsurprisingly, of nickel) is worth five pennies.

The Keep on the Bordermarch

The Pale Keep was built by the Crown of Albion in 3421 to fortify the bordermarch of the Pale against the Eire barbarians and their fey allies. The keep sits on a tall cliff overlooking a tributary of the Barrow river to the south; the entirety of the island across the Barrow is referred to as "beyond the Pale" by the March's inhabitants. The entire keep is hallowed ground, kept consecrated regularly by the abbey's priests.

The Drawbridge

The main gate of the keep is flanked by two 30-foot tall guard towers and a 20 foot tall gatehouse, which controls the keep's drawbridge. Everything is made of large granite stones, with various defensive slots to fire arrows out of. The gate leads to a small entry courtyard, paved with cobblestones and decorated with bright banners.

The watch corporal at the courtyard will direct all visitors to dismount and stable their horses or other mounts at the common stables. There are always d6+3 stable-boys and other attendants in the stables, which are quite clean and well-kept. Expect there to be 1d6-1 each of light courier horses, draft horses, and mules stabled at any given time, besides the party's mounts.

At the Corner

Beside the stables is a common warehouse. Anything that can't be reasonably carried, as well as any valuable goods, are required to be kept here while the party stays at the keep.

The bailiff's tower at the south end of the courtyard forms the corner of the keep and houses the bailiff, who is in charge of keeping the peace in the public sections of the keep. The bailiff is a third-level warrior and a well-to-do minor noble, wearing mastercraft +1 plate armor (defense 4) and wielding a mastercraft +1 longsword.

The South Wall Promenade

The south wall contains a series of five well-furnished private apartments, which house merchants and noble visitors to the keep. Opposite these lodgings are a blacksmith, a general store and a trader's shop. There is a path between the blacksmith's and the general store leading to a smaller back-street.

The blacksmith-in-residence is a level five dwarf dweomersmith, capable of crafting common or uncommon magic items. Unless the party contains a dwarf, convincing her to do so and agreeing upon a price will be an exercise in frustration. (There is a reason she has the trader handling sales for her, instead of simply selling her wares herself from her smithy.) Getting the trader involved in a negotiation for a magic item will smooth over the negotiations, at the cost of doubling the final price.

The general store stocks any reasonable mundane adventuring gear that the party might need, at standard prices. If the party asks about weapons or armor, the clerk will direct them next door to the trader's shop.

The trader's shop sells expensive high-class clothing, as well as arms and armor made by the blacksmith; any mundane arms or armor can be commissioned with a 2-3 day's advance notice (full plate or horse barding might instead take 1-2 weeks). The trader's wife is an accomplished seamstress who makes much of the merchandise on offer; as such, the trader is always interested in purchasing furs, hides, or other fabrics that the party might come across, as well as gold, jewelry, or any other potential ornamentation for her work.

The Main Courtyard

A bank and a guard tower mark the end of the promenade, and the entrance to the public courtyard; there are two more private apartments to the right. The courtyard itself is a wide open space with an ornate brickwork pattern and a large fountain serving as a focus. Behind the fountain is the *Golden Harp*, a traveller's inn and a tavern. There are five small private rooms at the inn which each cost 1 gold drac per night; there is also a communal sleeping area with twelve bunk beds, which costs a dime per bed per night.

The tavern is the main gathering place for most of the keep, with excellent food and drink, good entertainment, and a welcoming atmosphere. There are always at least 3d6 patrons active in the tavern at any time of day or night. A good hearty meal will cost between 1 and 5 silver dimes, while alcohol costs between 5 copper pennies and one drac, depending on the quality and type requested. The tavern is an excellent place to recruit hirelings, trade rumors, and gather information about the surrounding area.

The family that owns the tavern and inn lives in a set of private rooms on the top floor; the three children clean and serve food while the husband (Basil) and wife (Abagail) take turns as the barkeep. Buying an extra drink for either is a good way to pick up rumors about the surrounding area, some of which might actually be true. Roll a d20 whenever the party asks for local gossip:

D6 Rumor

1-2 A traveling merchant went missing recently, probably captured by orcs. The guild will pay a handsome reward for their return.

3 There's some kind of coalition of orc tribes building up in the caves to the east of here. They're up to no good. People have heard the name 'Crom Cruach' bandied about, which is never a good sign.

4 Travellers heading east have said they've seen an ogre recently, but Sir Edward says he needs more than rumors before he can justify doing something about it.

5 There's tribes of beastfolk and lizardfolk south of the river; tales tell that they're being goaded by some crazy hermit witch.

6 Some fancy priest showed up in town last week, seems like a nice enough fellow but he gives my wife the creeps.

The Back Street

Between the general store and the smithy on the promenade is a small street that leads to the merchant guild's headquarters, and two larger private dwellings; these currently house the banker and a wealthy human priest.

The banker is a second-level dweomersmith, living with his wife (a first-level delver) and two second-level dwarven stalwart guards from his clan. If bothered at home, they will gruffly direct the party to come to the bank during business hours.

The priest is a newcomer. During the day, he is likely to be found at the tavern; during the evening, he will retire to this dwelling, but will eagerly accept visitors. He is a third-level death priest with exceptional intelligence (+2) and a range of surprisingly well-thought-out philosophical views that he is eager to discuss with others, all backed up by an impressive wealth of theoretical and practical knowledge (his Science and Lore skills are each 2+).

He is also, unfortunately, a warlock in league with the Crom-Cruach cultists.

If the party mentions the orc caves or Crom Cruach, he will eagerly offer a scholar's wealth of information about the pagan god and its worship, interspersed with dire moral admonitions. If the party expresses interest in investigating the caves, he will eagerly volunteer to accompany them; he has a suit of mithral chainmail, a +1 bracer of shielding, and a +1 thunderhammer mace to bring to the party.

He will, if he can, lead the party directly into the demon's labyrinth, and attempt to offer them up as a sacrifice to the baal-malak.

Behind the guild's headquarters, the abbey is a single large cathedral with ornate stained glass windows, richly stained wood, and gilded symbols of faith framed in grey stone. The abbot in residence is Father Costello, a fifth level priest of the beauty domain, who wields an uncommon (+2) healer's staff; he is attended to by five acolytes – a third level priest of the death domain, a second level priest of the life domain, a second level priest of the fate domain, a first level priest of the truth domain, and a first level priest of the life domain.

The Gatehouse

The inner gatehouse separates the public area from the inner bailey. It is built like a small fortress, with sufficient defenses to repel most attackers. Visitors must first gain special permission before entering through the gatehouse into the inner bailey. There are 24 guards quartered within the inner gatehouse, each of which is a first level fighter with a longsword, medium shield, and chainmail. They are commanded by the captain of the guard, a third-level fighter, and his sergeant, a second-level fighter. Each possess a mastercraft +1 longsword; the sergeant also has a common amulet of protection.

The gatehouse is flanked by two watchtowers; each houses a ballista for repelling sieges. Each houses six guards at any moment, two of which are on post at the tops of the towers.

The Inner Bailey

The inner bailey is a large grassy field; during daylight hours, there are always at least two ten-man ranks of guards practicing their combat maneuvers here. The cavalry stables house 30 warhorses and 1d6 light courier horses at any given time, plus two stable hands and two guards.

The great tower in the northwest corner houses a storm cannon, an artifact siege weapon brought over from Albion at great expense to defend the keep against dragons, ogres, or any other large beastie that might come from beyond the Pale. The tower houses 24 guards, plus six engineers – the chief engineer is a level five wizard, while his five apprentices are all level three wizards. All are experts (2+) in Arcana, and all have their hands busy constantly maintaining and repairing their fickle weapon.

The keep's fortress dominates the far end of the courtyard. The front doors of the fortress steel-banded oak, 20 feet wide, and 15 feet high. The building itself is 30 feet tall, while the two flanking towers rise another 30 feet above it. Inside is a main courtyard, a great hall, and an armory. On the outside wall another pair of defensive towers each house a thunder-rattler siege weapon to defend against raiders attempting to climb the cliff. Atop the fortress are the guard's quarters and the lord's quarters.

The Lord-in-Residence

The lord of the keep is Sir Edward, a sixth-level paladin (warrior / war priest). He possesses an uncommon (+2) keen longsword, as well a legendary (+4) relic dagger which serves as the 'ignition key' for his golem armor, the Siege Perilous. When not piloting the Siege Perilous, he wears orichalc plate (defense 5) and a common (+1) bracer of shielding. His advisor, Dame MacGearalt, is a third level elven druid, mute from some ancient neck injury but capable of reading and writing in several dozen languages. She wears common (+1) living armor and wields a common (+1) short windbow with a common (+1) elemental quiver, usually kept charged with wood (poison) materia.

Sir Edward is a friendly man, and deeply committed to the defense of his people. He knows about the rumors of the orc caves and the ogre, but he feels that right now the beastfolk and lizardfolk across the river are the primary threat. He can't afford to send his men away from the keep to deal with something that's only a rumor; even if the party comes back with proof, he'll be more worried about leaving the keep undefended than about clearing out Crom Cruach's temple.

If persuaded, may be willing to send a squad of guards with the party to help clear out the caves. This will consist of nine first-level warriors from the gatehouse commanded by a second-level sergeant.

Beneath the Mountain

The main courtyard of the inner bailey has a secret lift built into the floor. In an emergency, Sir Edward or a sworn lieutenant can descend into the mountain with the keep's chief engineer, and activate the golem armor secured within: the Siege Perilous. The Siege Perilous is armed with a +2 keen longsword and a +3 mirror shield.

Also housed within the mountain are a team of dwarves: seven dweomersmiths (a ninth-level, two fifth-level, one third-level, and four first-level), twelve third-level stalwarts, and three third-level delvers. Their sworn duty is to maintain the Siege Perilous for the Crown; they will not hinder or assist any other task.

Dramatis Personae

Each NPC's statblock is split into three sections: abilities and saves, combat statistics, and skills and magic. An NPC that has to roll a skill that they don't have rolls vs. a 5+ threshold.

Bailiff (3hd Warrior)

Doom 12+ Hold 11+ Blast 12+ Trick 12+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+					
Movement: 5 paces			Size: Medium		
Armor: 4 (heavy +1)			HP: 3d6+6		
Attacks (11+):+1 longsword (d6+2)					
Con +0		Str +1		Dex +0	
Int +0		Wis +0		Cha +0	
Skills (4+): Bearing					

Watch Corporal (2hd Warrior)

Doom 12+ Hold 13+ Blast 13+ Trick 13+ Curse 13+ Fear 13+					
Movement: 5 paces			Size: Medium		
Armor: 3 (heavy)			HP: 2d6+6		
Attacks (13+): +1 longsword (d6+1)					
Con +1		Str +0		Dex +0	
Int +0		Wis +0		Cha +0	
Skills (4+): Bearing					

Gate Guards (1hd Warrior) x 5

Doom 14+ Hold 13+ Blast 14+ Trick 14+ Curse 14+ Fear 14+					
Movement: 5 paces			Size: Medium		
Armor: 2 (medium)			HP: 8		
Attacks (12+): longsword (d6)					
Con +0	Str +1	Dex +0	Int +0	Wis +0	Cha +0
Skills (5+): None of note					

Peacekeepers (1hd Warrior) x 10

Doom 14+ Hold 13+ Blast 14+ Trick 14+ Curse 14+ Fear 14+					
Movement: 5 paces			Size: Medium		
Armor: 2 (medium)			HP: 8		
Attacks (12+): longsword (d6)					
Con +0	Str +1	Dex +0	Int +0	Wis +0	Cha +0
Skills (5+): None of note					

Blacksmith (Level 3 Dweomersmith)

Doom 11+ Hold 11+ Blast 12+ Trick 11+ Curse 12+ Fear 13+	
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium
Armor: 3 (medium +1)	HP: 3d6+6
Attacks (11+): Thundering warhammer (3d6+1 blunt)	
Con +1 Str +1 Dex +0 Int +1 Wis +0 Cha -1	
Skills (3+): Finesse, Science	
Magic: The blacksmith can forge common or uncommon arcane magic items.	

Banker (Level 2 Dweomersmith)

Doom 12+ Hold 12+ Blast 14+ Trick 12+ Curse 12+ Fear 13+						
Movement: 5 paces			Size: Medium			
Armor: 2 (light +)			HP: 2d6+4			
Attacks (13+): Revolver (d6 piercing + d6 thunder)						
Con +1	Str +1	Dex -1	Int +1	Wis +1	Cha +0	
Skills (4+): Finesse, Science, Intuition						
Magic: The banker can identify magic items as a ritual						

Bank Guard (Level 2 Stalwart) x 2

Doom 12+ Hold 12+ Blast 13+ Trick 13+ Curse 13+ Fear 13+	
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium
Armor: 4 (heavy +1)	HP: 2d6+6
Attacks (12+): Thundermace (d6+1 blunt + d6 thunder)	
Con +1 Str +1 Dex +0 Int +0 Wis +0 Cha +0	
Skills (4+): Finesse	

Banker's Wife (Level 1 Delver)

Doom 13+ Hold 13+ Blast 13+ Trick 14+ Curse 14+ Fear 14+					
Movement: 5 paces			Size: Medium		
Armor: 3 (medium +1)			HP: 8		
Attacks (12+): Musket (d6+1 piercing + d6+1 thunder)					
Con +1	Str +1	Dex +1	Int +0	Wis +0	Cha +0
Skills (4+): Agility, Stealth					

Innkeeper (Human Civilian)

Doom 15+ Hold 15+ Blast 15+ Trick 15+ Curse 15+ Fear 14+					
Movement: 5 paces			Size: Medium		
Armor: 0			HP: 6		
Attacks (12+): Unarmed (d6 blunt)					
Con +0	Str +0	Dex +0	Int +0	Wis +0	Cha +1
Skills (4+): Charm					

Innkeeper's Wife (Level 2 Bard)

Con +0 Str +0 Dex +1 Int +0 Wis +0 Cha +2	
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium
Armor: 0	HP: 2d6
Attacks (12+): Unarmed (d6 blunt)	
Con +0 Str +0 Dex +1 Int +0 Wis +0 Cha +2	
Skills (4+): Finesse, Lore, Wit, Charm	
Magic: Abigail has one faith, which she can spend to cast any first-circle beauty miracle.	

Abbot Costello (5hd Priest)

Doom 11+ Hold 10+ Blast 10+ Trick 10+ Curse 9+ Fear 8+

Movement: 5 paces Size: Medium

Armor: 2 (light +1) HP: 5d6-5

Attacks (12+): healer's staff quarterstaff (1d6 blunt)

Con -1 Str +0 Dex +1 Int +0 Wis +0 Cha +2

Skills (3+): Lore, Intuition, Charm, Wit

Magic: Costello has five faith, which he can use to perform any miracle from the beauty domain or prepare miracles from other domains.

Brother Hugh (3hd Priest)

Doom 14+ Hold 12+ Blast 12+ Trick 12+ Curse 11+ Fear 11+

Movement: 5 paces Size: Medium

Armor: 1 (light) HP: 3d6-3

Attacks (12+): quarterstaff (1d6 blunt / reach)

Con -1 Str +0 Dex +0 Int +0 Wis +1 Cha +1

Skills (4+): Lore, Intuition, Bearing

Magic: Hugh has three faith, which he can use to perform any first- or second-circle miracle from the death domain, or prepare miracles from other domains..

Brother Watt (2hd Priest)

Doom 11+ Hold 13+ Blast 13+ Trick 13+ Curse 12+ Fear 11+

Movement: 5 paces Size: Medium

Armor: 1 (light) HP: 5d6-5

Attacks (13+): mace (1d6 blunt)

Con -1 Str +0 Dex +0 Int +0 Wis +1 Cha +2

Skills (4+): Intuition, Bearing, Wit

Magic: Watt has two faith, which he can use to perform any first-circle miracle from the fate domain.

Sister Ida Noe (2hd Priest)

Doom 13+ Hold 13+ Blast 13+ Trick 13+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+

Movement: 5 paces Size: Medium

Armor: 2 (medium) HP: 2d6

Attacks (13+): frying pan (1d6 blunt)

Con +0 Str +0 Dex +0 Int +0 Wis +0 Cha +1

Skills (4+): Intuition, Charm

Magic: Ida has two faith, which she can use to perform any first-circle miracle from the life domain.

Brother Today-for-Today (1hd Priest)

Doom 14+ Hold 14+ Blast 14+ Trick 14+ Curse 13+ Fear 13+

Movement: 5 paces Size: Medium

Armor: 1 (light) HP: 5d6-5

Attacks (12+): mace (1d6 blunt)

Con +0 Str +0 Dex +0 Int +0 Wis +1 Cha +1

Skills (4+): Intuition, Bearing

Magic: Today has two faith, which he can use to perform any first-circle miracle from the truth domain.

Sister To-the-Morrow (1hd Priest)

Doom 15+ Hold 14+ Blast 14+ Trick 14+ Curse 13+ Fear 12+

Movement: 5 paces Size: Medium

Armor: 1 (light) HP: 5d6-5

Attacks (14+): mace (1d6 blunt)

Con -1 Str +0 Dex +0 Int +0 Wis +1 Cha +2

Skills (4+): Intuition, Bearing, Charm

Magic: Tomorrow two one faith, which she can use to perform any first-circle miracle from the life domain.

“Brother” Seamus (5hd Warlock)

Doom 10+ Hold 10+ Blast 10+ Trick 8+ Curse 9+ Fear 8+

Movement: 5 paces Size: Medium

Armor: 3 (medium +1) HP: 5d6

Attacks (12+): thundermace (d6 blunt+d6 thunder)

Con +0 Str +0 Dex +0 Int +2 Wis +1 Cha +2

Skills (3+): Stealth, Lore, Medicine, Bearing, Charm, Wit

Magic: James has five faith, which he can use to perform any miracle from the death domain, or prepare any other miracle into a prayer strip.

Sir Edward Fitz-Eustace (L5 Paladin)

Doom 10+ Hold 9+ Blast 9+ Trick 10+ Curse 9+ Fear 9+					
Movement: 5 paces			Size: Medium		
Armor: 4 (heavy +1)			HP: 5d6+10		
Attacks (7+): +2 keen longsword (2d6+4)					
Con +0	Str +1	Dex +1	Int +0	Wis +1	Cha +1
Skills (4+): Stealth, Alertness, Bearing					
Magic: Sir Edward has three faith, which he can use to perform any first- or second-circle miracle from the War domain, or prepare any other first- or second-circle miracle into a prayer strip.					

Dame Caitrin MacGeralt (L5 Druid)

Doom 10+ Hold 10+ Blast 9+ Trick 10+ Curse 9+ Fear 9+					
Movement: 5 paces			Size: Medium		
Armor: 2 (light +1)			HP: 5d6		
Attacks (10+):windbow (1d6+1 piercing / 20 paces)					
Con +0	Str +0	Dex +1	Int +0	Wis +1	Cha +1
Skills (4+): Intuition, Survival					
Senses: Keen Senses (elf)					
Magic: Dame MacGeralt has five glamour, which she can use to perform any fey or beast glamour. She is also attuned to two wisp companions: a wood wisp and an air wisp.					

Chief Engineer O'Brien (5hd Engineer)

Doom 10+ Hold 10+ Blast 9+ Trick 8+ Curse 9+ Fear 10+					
Movement: 5 paces			Size: Medium		
Armor: 3 (medium +1)			HP: 3d6+6		
Attacks (*): stormcannon (3D6 structural lightning)					
Con +0	Str +0	Dex +1	Int +2	Wis +1	Cha +0
Skills (2+): Lore, Science					
Magic: The chief engineer usually has all of his spell preparations used to keep the exceptionally finicky storm cannon operational.					

Apprentice Engineer (3hd Engineer) x 5

Doom 12+ Hold 12+ Blast 12+ Trick 11+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+					
Movement: 5 paces			Size: Medium		
Armor: 2 (medium)			HP: 3d6+6		
Attacks (*): magic missile (d6 at 10 paces)					
Con +0	Str +0	Dex +0	Int +1	Wis +0	Cha +0
Skills (3+): Lore, Science					
Magic: Each assistant engineer usually has the identify magic and arcane bolt spells prepared.					

Captain of the Guard (3hd Warrior)

Doom 12+ Hold 11+ Blast 12+ Trick 12+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+					
Movement: 5 paces			Size: Medium		
Armor: 3 (medium +1)			HP: 3d6+6		
Attacks (11+): +1 longsword (d6+2)					
Con +0		Str +1		Dex +0	
Int +0		Wis +0		Cha +0	
Skills (4+): Bearing					

Sergeant-at-Arms (2hd Warrior)

Doom 12+ Hold 13+ Blast 13+ Trick 13+ Curse 13+ Fear 13+					
Movement: 5 paces			Size: Medium		
Armor: 3 (medium +1)		HP: 2d6+6			
Attacks (13+):+1 longsword (d6+1)					
Con +1	Str +0	Dex +0	Int +0	Wis +0	Cha +0
Skills (4+): Bearing					

Ranger of the Pale (2hd Scout) x 12

Doom 13+ Hold 13+ Blast 12+ Trick 13+ Curse 13+ Fear 13+					
Movement: 5 paces			Size: Medium		
Armor: 1 (light)			HP: 2d6		
Attacks (12+): longbow (d6)					
Con +0	Str +0	Dex +1	Int +0	Wis +0	Cha +0
Skills (4+): Agility, Finesse, Stealth, Perception					

Man-At-Arms (1hd Warrior) x 50

Doom 14+ Hold 13+ Blast 14+ Trick 14+ Curse 14+ Fear 14+					
Movement: 5 paces			Size: Medium		
Armor: 2 (medium)			HP: 8		
Attacks (12+): longsword (d6)					
Con +0	Str +1	Dex +0	Int +0	Wis +0	Cha +0
Skills (5+): None of note					

Siege Perilous

(Scout-Class Golem Armor)

The Siege Perilous is a golem armor — an 18 foot tall iron giant, with a space in the chest for a mortal wearing a special harness to sit and control it with their own actions. It is an ancient relic of the Old Empire, deeded to whoever is charged with protecting the Keep and the Pale from all threats.

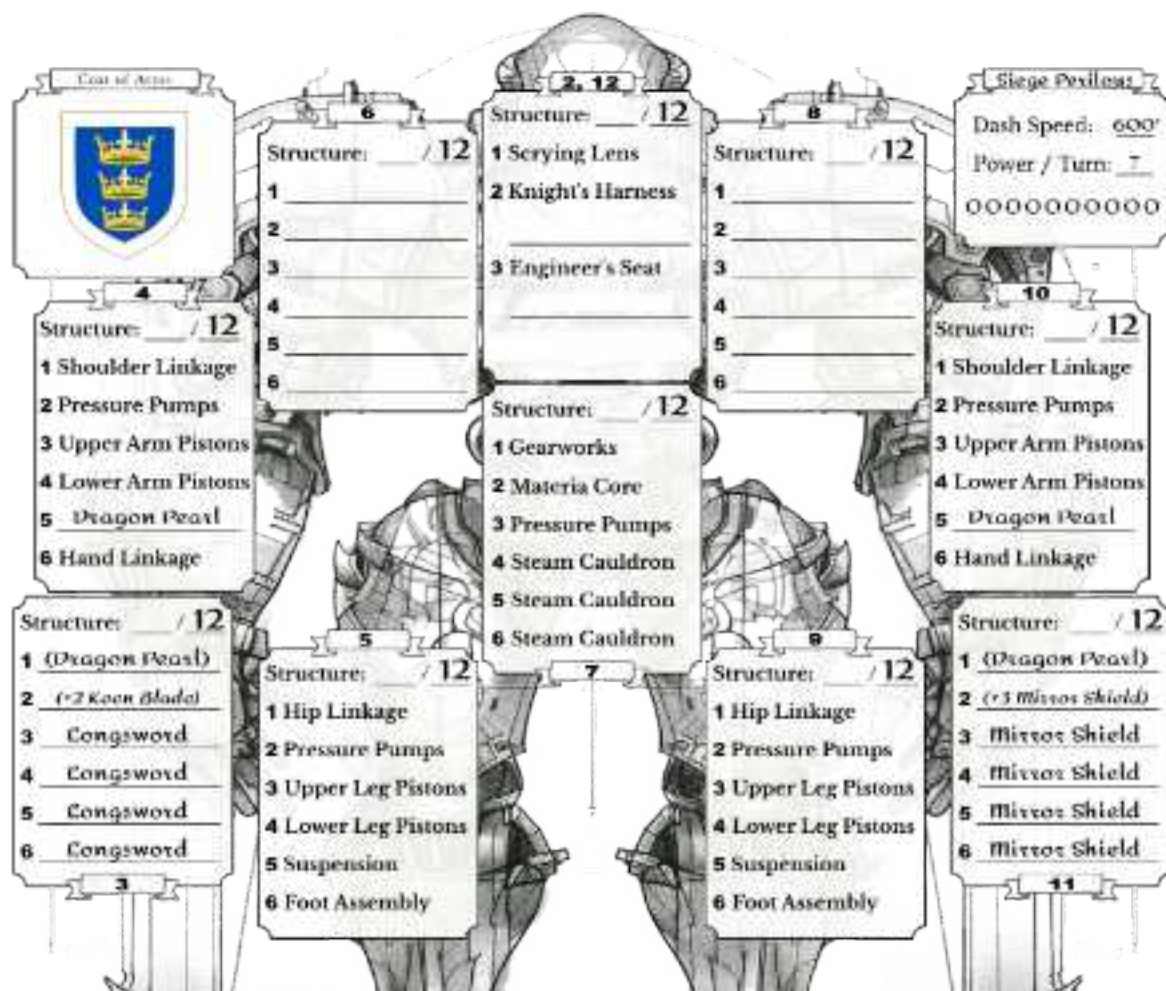
Piloting the Siege Perilous requires two characters working in tandem: the golem knight wears the knight's harness (a special suit of full plate armor) and controls the golem armor's movements, while the engineer sits below him in the engineer's seat, and tends the golem armor's arcane systems.

The Siege Perilous' shoulders were originally designed to carry siege cannons or modular field equipment, which could be swapped in and out depending on the needs of a campaign. These have long since succumbed to the ravages of time, leaving the Siege Perilous with only what it can carry in its enormous fists.

Huge Construct - the Siege Perilous is a large steel structure, which means that normal weapons, spells, and other attacks that deal hit point damage only deal 1 point of structure damage to it per damage die that rolls a '6'. Its structure points are divided into eight sections; roll 2d6 each time it is hit to determine which section takes the damage, unless the attacker uses their reaction as they attack to take careful aim to choose which section to damage.

The Siege Perilous's +2 keen longsword deals 5d6+35 hp damage, or 1d6+7 structure damage, per hit. The sword and the golem armor are also consecrated, allowing Sir Edward (or any other priest of the War domain) to channel War-domain magics through it.

Critical Hits - If the Siege Perilous suffers a critical hit to any of its sections, or suffers damage in excess of its structure, roll 1d6 per critical hit or excess damage and destroy the internal component indicated. Each of these components is a rare magic item, which can only be repaired by a 9th-level dweomersmith.



Beyond the Pale

Traveling outside the keep is reasonably fast and straightforward, as long as the party keeps to the road. Each large hex is one-half mile, while each small hex is 100 paces (500 feet); along the road, the party can travel one large hex per exploration round while on foot or in a wagon. Across the open fields, this slows to three small hexes per exploration round; trudging through rivers, swampland, or forests slows the party to one hex per exploration round, and requires a Survival check to not get bogged down. Stopping to fully investigate a single small hex is also an exploration action.

Just across the river to the south, the marshes house tribes of beastfolk and lizardfolk orcs who have been harassing the keep since it was first built. The lizardfolk nest is in a series of barrow-mounds, while the wolf-beastfolk tribe's current camp is in the woods. East of them, on an abandoned trail running through the woods, are two ettercap centaurs.

All three groups would quickly descend into petty infighting if not for an elven hermit druid, who each tribe independently respects. The elf bears a serious grudge against the Albians, and has been working for centuries to drive them off "her island". She lives in a small hovel south of the abandoned trail, with only her animal companion for consistent company (a large and surly leopard).

Two miles or so north, on the keep's side of the river, is an abandoned temple to Crom Cruach. The temple is inside a cave system in a grotto that is hidden within the forest. The temple and surrounding caverns are inhabited by several tribes of beastfolk, lizardfolk, and goblin orcs, all of whom have come to worship under the direction of an evil pagan warlock cult dedicated to the Crooked God.

Keeping the Adventure Alive

A large part of the referee's job is to give the players a sense that they are in a living, evolving world. You can use the following d20 table to create a "ratchet" of escalating events to simulate the passage of time and keep the pressure on the party. If the party is sufficiently proactive, or if the "ratchet" style of advancing doom doesn't fit your table's

style of play, you are free to ignore this table.

After the players spend a week at the keep, roll a d20 and consult the following table; on each subsequent week that the caves are left alone, add a cumulative +1 modifier to this roll. Clearing out one of the factions in the caves will reduce the "ratchet" by 1d6, or more if the referee feels that the cultists' plans have been thwarted more substantially.

D20	Event
1-5	No Event
6-7	A random prisoner of the Skitterglint clan is eaten by the ogre.
8-9	A random prisoner of the Skitterglint clan is eaten by the bugbear; roll 1d6: on a '1', the bugbear grows into another ogre, and both ogres immediately fight until one is defeated. The defeated ogre moves into the forest; if '8-9' is rolled subsequently, travelers along the road between the forest and the river are waylaid by the exiled ogre.
10	The ettercap's egg sac hatches. If '10' is rolled subsequently, it indicates that travelers along the road between the forest and the river are waylaid by wandering ettercap young.
11-13	Travelers along the road near Crom's cave are kidnapped by the wolf clan.
14-16	Travelers along the road near Crom's cave are kidnapped by the Skitterglint hobgoblins.
17	Travelers along the road between the forest and the river are kidnapped by lizardfolk and eaten.
18	Travelers along the road between the forest and the river are waylaid by marauding wolf clan barbarians; a single survivor is sent back to the keep with ransom demands.
19+	A random prisoner in the wolf clan lair is given to the (odd) priests and sacrificed, increasing the demon's power by 1 hd. Increase this d20 roll's cumulative modifier by +1d6.
20+	A prisoner in the Skitterglint clan lair is given to the (even) priests and sacrificed, increasing the demon's power by 1 hd. Increase this d20 roll's cumulative modifier by +1d6.

Once the demon's power reaches 10 hd, the next subsequent roll of 19+ instead triggers an all-out assault on the keep by every monster in the area. The referee is encouraged to use the mass combat rules found in the Referee's Guide to simulate this encounter; the assault will definitely bring out the Siege Perilous and many ranks of the keep's guards in formation — both mounted cavalry and foot soldiers —

Lizardfolk Barrow

This lizardfolk tribe operates primarily at night, sending hunters to attack any travellers along the road in the large hex directly northeast of their barrow, just out of view of the keep.

Their forces currently consist of three first-level champions wielding javelins, six first-level hunters wielding shortbows, one third-level druid (called the “bone mother” in the tribe’s native tongue) who has an uncommon bag of holding, eight young (who will flee or hide rather than attack) and six eggs.

The bone-mother’s bag of holding is currently full of severed heads, which the bag’s enchantment is keeping fresh. An examination of the cooking pot and refuse around the barrow will suggest that severed heads are a delicacy for the kobolds.

These kobolds originally lived in a cave in Crum Cruach’s grotto, but were decimated and pushed out by the Blacktooth goblin clan. They are extremely resentful of this, and would eagerly accept help reclaiming their ancestral warrens — after which they are likely to reward the party’s help by cooking and eating them. If the party talks their way into allying with the tribe to re-take their warrens and then tries to talk their way out of being eaten, the tribe will explain that anyone whose brain is eaten by the tribe gets reborn into the tribe, and so cooking and eating the party is the tribe’s way of welcoming them permanently into their family.

Kobold Bone Mother (3hd)

Doom 12+ Hold 12+ Blast 11+ Trick 11+ Curse 11+ Fear 12+					
Movement: 5 paces			Size: Small		
Armor: 2 (natural scales)			HP: 3d6÷2		
Attacks (12+): quarterstaff (2d6 blunt)					
Con +0		Str +1		Dex +1	
Int +1		Wis +1		Cha +0	
Skills (4+): Stealth, Medicine, Intuition, Survival					
Magic: 3 glamour					

Kobold Champions (1hd) x 3

Doom 14+ Hold 13+ Blast 13+ Trick 15+ Curse 14+ Fear 14+					
Movement: 5 paces			Size: Small		
Armor: 2 (natural scales)			HP: 4		
Attacks (13+): Javelin (2d6 or 1d6 / range 5)					
Feats: Snake Frenzy					
Con +0	Str +1	Dex +1	Int -1	Wis +0	Cha +0
Skills					
(4+): Stealth					

Kobold Hunters (1hd) x 6

Doom 14+ Hold 13+ Blast 13+ Trick 15+ Curse 14+ Fear 14+					
Movement: 5 paces			Size: Small		
Armor: 2 (natural scales)			HP: 3		
Attacks (12+): Shortbow (1d6+1 piercing / range 10)					
Feats: Sneak Attack					
Con +0		Str +1		Dex +1	
Int -1		Wis +0		Cha +0	
Skills (4+): Stealth					

Wolf Beastfolk Camp

The beastfolk tribe consists of five pucca and six fauns. When attacked, the pucca will immediately transform into wolves and attack as a pack, while the fauns fall back into defensive positions around their druid.

The pucca pack consists of a third-level wolf pucca champion, two second-level wolf pucca champions, and two second-level wolf pucca hunters. All fight with only their natural hide and claw in wolf form, but can fall back to the keep, transform, and acquire greatswords if the need arises. The third-level champion will grab a +1 keen battleaxe.

The faun pack consists of two first-level wolf faun champions with hide armor and greatswords, three first-level wolf faun hunters with leather armor and greatbows, and one first-level wolf faun druid with a quarterstaff, a dagger, and common (+1) thornweave hide.

Pucca Chieftain (3hd)

Doom 12+ Hold 10+ Blast 11+ Trick 13+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+	
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium
Armor: 2 (light +1)	HP: 3d6+6
Attacks (10+): +1 keen battleaxe (2d6+6 sundering)	
Feats: Wolf Frenzy	
Con +0 Str +2 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0	
Skills (5+): Agility, Stealth, Perception, Survival	
Wolf Form: The pucca's natural form is a wolf.	

Wolf Form (3hd)

Doom 11+ Hold 10+ Blast 10+ Trick 15+ Curse 11+ Fear 11+					
Con +1 (11+)		Str +2 (10+)		Dex +2 (10+)	
Int -3 (15+)		Wis +1 (11+)		Cha +1 (11+)	
Movement: Fast			Size: Medium		
Armor: 1 (light)			HP: 3d6+3		
Attacks (10+): bite (d6+2 piercing), grapple (2d6)					
Con +1	Str +2	Dex +2	Int -3	Wis +1	Cha +1
Skills (3+): Stealth, Perception, Survival					
Senses: Smell (superior)					

Pucca Champions (2hd)

x 2

Doom 13+ Hold 12+ Blast 12+ Trick 14+ Curse 13+ Fear 13+	
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium
Armor: 2 (light +1)	HP: 2d6+4
Attacks (12+): Greatsword (2d6+1)	
Feats: Wolf Frenzy	
Con +0 Str +1 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0	
Skills (5+): Agility, Stealth, Perception, Survival	
Wolf Form: The pucca's natural form is a wolf.	

Pucca Hunters (2hd)

x 2

Doom 13+ Hold 12+ Blast 12+ Trick 14+ Curse 13+ Fear 13+					
Movement: 5 paces		Size: Medium			
Armor: 1 (light)		HP: 2d6+2			
Attacks (12+): Two daggers (2d6 piercing)					
Feats: Sneak Attack					
Con +0		Str +1	Dex +1	Int -1	Wis +0 Cha +0
Skills (4+): Stealth, Alertness					
Wolf Form: The pucca's natural form is a wolf.					

Faun Champions (1hd)

x 2

Doom 14+ Hold 13+ Blast 13+ Trick 15+ Curse 14+ Fear 14+					
Movement: 5 paces			Size: Medium		
Armor: 1 (light)			HP: 8		
Attacks (13+): Greataxe (2d6+1 sundering)					
Feats: Wolf Frenzy					
Con +0		Str +1	Dex +1	Int -1	Wis +0
Cha +0					
Skills (5+): None of note					

Faun Hunters (1hd)

x 3

Doom 14+ Hold 13+ Blast 13+ Trick 15+ Curse 14+ Fear 14+					
Movement: 5 paces			Size: Medium		
Armor: 1 (light)			HP: 7		
Attacks (13+): Two daggers (2d6 piercing)					
Feats: Sneak Attack					
Con +0		Str +1	Dex +1	Int -1	Wis +0
Cha +0					
Skills (5+): Stealth, Alertness					

Faun Druid (1hd)

x 1

Doom 14+ Hold 13+ Blast 13+ Trick 15+ Curse 13+ Fear 14+					
Movement:		5 paces		Size: Medium	
Armor:		3 (thornweave)		HP: 1d6	
Attacks (12+): quarterstaff (2d6 blunt)					
Con +0	Str +1	Dex +1	Int -1	Wis +1	Cha +0
Skills (5+): Stealth, Alertness					
Magic:		1 glamour			

Ettercap Nest

The two ettercap centaurs that have woven their web within these pine barrens are a third-level champion and a second-level hunter. The champion has hidden her egg sac with hundreds of young in the trees to the southeast, and will be fiercely protective of it against anyone who approaches.

Both ettercaps have woven fine nets of barely-visible spidersilk across the entire path here, and typically lay in ambush hidden within a camouflaged tunnel beneath the wagon-path. Bound into the female's web inside the eastern alcove within the tunnel is the dessicated corpse of a wolf-pucca hunter; his gear has long since rotted into uselessness except for a common (+1) bracer of shielding which can be restored to full use by any wizard or dweomersmith.

Ettercap Champion (3hd)

Doom 11+ Hold 11+ Blast 11+ Trick 13+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+					
Movement:	Climb 5 paces			Size:	Medium
Armor:	2 (natural chitin)			HP:	3d6+9
Attacks (12+): Two daggers (2d6 piercing, poisoned)					
Feats:	Snake Frenzy				
Con +1	Str +1	Dex +1	Int -1	Wis +0	Cha +0
Skills (4+): Stealth					

Ettercap Hunter (2hd)

Doom 12+ Hold 13+ Blast 12+ Trick 14+ Curse 13+ Fear 13+					
Movement:	Climb 5 paces		Size:	Medium	
Armor:	2 (natural chitin)		HP:	2d6+4	
Attacks (12+): Two daggers (2d6 piercing, poisoned)					
Feats: Sneak Attack					
Con +1	Str +0	Dex +1	Int -1	Wis +0	Cha +0
Skills (4+): Stealth, Alertness					

The Hermit's Hollow

The hermit is a third-level elven druid with a leopard and a pair of wisps for company. She has built her home within a huge hollowed-out oak, which has been concealed (along with the surrounding well and gardens) by a fey illusion spell. She has learned two wild shapes which she uses to navigate the forest — a horned owl for reconnaissance, and a black bear for fighting.

The hermit usually has one wood and one fey attunement prepared, wears a common (+1) thornweave hide, and wields two daggers which she coats in death poison (treat as a critical hit if any damage is dealt).

If approached in earnest, she will present herself as a devout hermit who has isolated herself to worship in nature; while this is technically true, she is also violently prejudiced against the Albians and their allies, and will strive to murder the entire party at the first opportunity that presents itself.

The hermit's house itself holds very little of value, but there is a well-stocked apothecary in the cellar with 2d6 charges of materia from each element, a potion of invisibility, and an orichalc +1 keen dagger (shaped as a sickle). There are also various rare alchemical ingredients, including cave spider silk, exotic leathers, and a cured leopard's pelt (usable as hide armor). There are also five common dream pearls buried around her dwelling, each of which is currently maintaining one of the fey illusions that conceal her home.

The Hermit (3hd)

Doom 12+ Hold 13+ Blast 10+ Trick 12+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+					
Movement: 5 paces		Size: Medium			
Armor: 2 (light +1)		HP: 3d6			
Attacks (15+):two daggers (2d6 piercing, poisoned)					
Con +0	Str -1	Dex +2	Int +1	Wis +1	Cha +1
Skills (4+): Finesse, Stealth, Medicine, Survival, Charm					
Magic: 3 glamour					

Leopard (3hd)

Doom 11+ Hold 9+ Blast 9+ Trick 16+ Curse 11+ Fear 12+					
Movement: 5 paces		Size: Medium			
Armor: 0		HP: (3d6+3)x2			
Attacks (9+): bite (2d6 piercing), claws (2d6+3)					
Con +1 Str +3 Dex +3 Int -4 Wis +1 Cha +0					
Skills (3+): Agility, Stealth, Alertness, Survival					
Senses: Smell (superior)					

The Caves of Crom-Cruach

The source of the recent orc raids is a cavern system located in a deep ravine east of the Pale Keep, on the Albion side of the Barrow river. An ancient shrine to Orcus, known to the locals as Crom-Cruach, has languished here for centuries; a barbarian tribe has recently re-discovered the ruins, and are performing dark rituals to Crom-Cruach in return for power to drive off the Albians. In their endeavors, they have recruited local tribes of goblins, beastfolk, and lizardfolk to join their cause; each tribe has claimed and taken up residence in their own area of the cave network.

The Grotto

The grotto itself is a wide, heavily forested ravine with limestone cliff walls. Several caves can be seen from the ground, with more presumably hidden by the foliage. The entire area is difficult terrain, and the party must move through it single-file. Strewn about the ground here and there are the bones of various beasts along with the bones of goblins, kobolds, men, and dwarves, all scored with the tell-tale gnaw-marks of cannibalism.

The area often has a hunting party of 8 reasonably well-camouflaged (Stealth 3+) kobolds hiding in the trees, guarding the entrance to their cave. Roll a d20; on a 1-7, these kobold “guards” are present. A hard Perception check will notice them, but only if a party member is on-watch and specifically asks if they see anyone hidden in the trees.

If the d20 rolls a ‘19’ or ‘20’, then instead a larger threat is present – the ogre at 19, or the ursagryph at 20. Either creature represents a substantial threat to the adventuring party; each member of the party should save vs. fear before proceeding, and all those who fail will be shaken (all their attack rolls are harder).

Inter-Clan Relations

The lizardfolk, beastfolk, and goblin clans dwelling in the caves are in a constant state of low-level intertribal warfare with each other, kept barely in check by the priests of the shrine. A clever party of adventurers might be able to inflame tensions sufficiently to incite an all-out war, then exploit the chaos to loot the caves, or wait and clear out the weakened survivors after hostilities cool off.

The kobolds in particular resent the goblin clans living above them, who kicked them out of the choice caves and decimated their population in the process. These two clans, in turn, are constantly engaged in low-level fighting with each other, but their chiefs maintain a kind of “diplomacy” to ally against the much larger goblin clan across the grotto. Meanwhile, the two beastfolk clans are constantly fighting each other; the wolf clan has been regularly taking captives from the boar clan and serving them for dinner.

Everyone knows to avoid the ursagryph cave and the demon’s labyrinth at the far end of the grotto. The actual priests of Crom Cruach, in the highest cave at the grotto’s far end, have their hands full keeping everyone from killing each other, and regularly invite clan leaders to offer dark blessings or auguries in exchange for a barely-kept peace.

Emptying the Caves

If the party kills or drives off the inhabitants of one of the caves and then leaves, the priests in the shrine will seek to collect and re-animate any corpses that they can; within 2-3 weeks, they will have recruited a new group to replace them. Roll a d6 to determine the composition of the new group:

D20	Group Type
1-8	Lizardfolk
9-12	Goblins
13-14	Bear Beastfolk
15-16	Wolf Beastfolk
17-18	Boar Beastfolk
19-20	Ettercaps

A new tribe will consist of a third-level shaman, a third-level champion chieftain, two second-level champion lieutenants, and a second-level hunter lieutenant, as well as 1d6 first-level champions and 2d6 first-level hunters.

The Kobold Warrens

This is the first cavern entrance on the left, at the bottom of the ravine. Kobold hunting parties frequently enter and exit the cave; as the party approaches the entrance, there is a 2 in 6 chance that a hunting party has seen their approach and is hiding in the trees to ambush them.

The kobolds have dug a pit-trap 20' in from the entrance, which will support the weight of a kobold but will collapse if walked on by a medium or larger creature.

An alcove is set up as a guard post; at any given time, 1d6 1hd kobold hunters, each wielding javelins and small shields, will be stationed here to guard their home.

The garbage pile is infested with unusually large rats, many of which carry the Black Plague in their bite. There are 2d6 giant rats hiding within the garbage pile at any given time. Anyone bitten by a rat that rolls a critical hit should make an easy save vs. disease to determine whether they contract an infection; rolling a '1' on this saving throw indicates that the infection is the Plague.

The salted jerky, grains, beer, and wine in the larder are of low quality and barely edible; moreso, some of the jerky was very clearly once human or elven.

A guard station contains two human-sized troglodyte hunter guards (2hd each). Each is wearing hides and wielding a shortbow, which they will eagerly use to shoot any non-lizardfolk that approach this area.

The kobold bone-mother has her own private lair behind the guard station. She is a level 3 druid, and serves as the leader of the tribe. Hidden in her study are 1d6 materia charges.

The kobold's common den is at the end of the other hallway. There are 3d6 kobold hunter males and 4d6 kobold champion females. This room also contains 1d6+1 pregnant or brooding kobold mothers and 2d6 kobold young (who will flee or hide rather than fight), and several large clutches of eggs. Hidden among their nests is 3d6 sp and an uncommon (+2) robe of splendour, which one of them is using as bedding. These items will not be found without a search, however.

Kobold Bone Mother (3 HD)

Doom 12+	Hold 12+	Blast 11+	Trick 12+	Curse 11+	Fear 12+
Movement:	5 paces	Size:	Small		
Armor:	2 (natural scales)	HP:	3d6+2		
Attacks (12+):	quarterstaff (2d6 blunt)				
Con +0	Str +0	Dex +1	Int +0	Wis +1	Cha +0
Skills (4+):	Arcana, Animal Ken, Survival, Wit				
Magic:	3 glamour				

Troglodyte Hunters (2 HD) x 2

Doom 13+	Hold 12+	Blast 12+	Trick 14+	Curse 13+	Fear 13+
Movement:	5 paces	Size:	Medium		
Armor:	2 (natural scales)	HP:	2d6+4		
Attacks (12+):	Shortbow (1d6 piercing / range 10)				
Feats:	Sneak Attack				
Con +0	Str +1	Dex +1	Int -1	Wis +0	Cha +0
Skills (5+):	Agility, Finesse, Stealth, Perception				

Kobold Hunters (1 HD) x 4d6

Doom 14+	Hold 13+	Blast 13+	Trick 15+	Curse 14+	Fear 14+
Movement:	5 paces	Size:	Small		
Armor:	2 (natural scales)	HP:	3		
Attacks (13+):	Shortbow (1d6 piercing / range 10)				
Feats:	Sneak Attack				
Con +0	Str +1	Dex +1	Int -1	Wis +0	Cha +0
Skills (5+):	Agility, Finesse, Stealth, Perception				

Kobold Champions (1 HD) x 4d6

Doom 14+	Hold 13+	Blast 13+	Trick 15+	Curse 14+	Fear 14+
Movement:	5 paces	Size:	Small		
Armor:	2 (natural scales)	HP:	4		
Attacks (13+):	Javelin (2d6 or 1d6 / range 5)				
Feats:	Snake Frenzy				
Con +0	Str +1	Dex +1	Int -1	Wis +0	Cha +0
Skills (5+):	Stealth				

Giant Rat (1hd) x 2d6

Doom 16+	Hold 16+	Blast 13+	Trick 17+	Curse 13+	Fear 15+
Movement:	5 paces	Size:	Small		
Armor:	0	HP:	2		
Attacks (15+):	bite (d6 piercing, diseased)				
Con -2	Str -2	Dex +1	Int -4	Wis +1	Cha -1
Skills (3+):	Agility, Stealth, Alertness, Survival				
Senses:	Smell (superior)				
Behavior (d6):	1-2 fearful, 3-5 wary, 6 aggressive				

Blacktooth Clan Lair

This cave is directly above the kobold warrens. Before the goblins arrived, these caves were part of the kobold warrens — a fact that the kobolds have not forgotten, and still hold considerable resentment about.

The wall facing the entrance is covered with the grizzly trophies of human, goblin, and lizardfolk heads and skulls in various stages of decay. There is a small window hidden by a grey cloth, where a 2hd hobgoblin hunter guard from the alcove can poke their head through and keep watch, while appearing to be one of the trophy-heads.

The guard room is regularly staffed by four 2hd hobgoblin champions, each armed with a spear and a medium shield. They are positioned around a gambling table; each guard has 2d6+3 electrum quarters that they are wagering at games of dice. The next guard room has four more 3hd hobgoblin guards; they report to the forward guard and will join him in repelling any invaders.

There is a mess hall filled with benches and tables, with a fireplace inset into the far wall. On a d20 roll of '1', the 3hd bugbear champion chieftain is holding court here, and the room is filled with 2d6 x 2hd hobgoblins and 3d6 x 1hd redcaps. Otherwise, the room is empty, but a small charcoal fire is still burning in the fireplace.

The common room quarters 2d6 x 2hd male hobgoblin champions, 3d6 x 2hd female hobgoblin hunters, and 2d6 redcap young (1hd each, will flee or hide rather than fighting). Each of the hobgoblins will have 1d6 silver in their pockets.

The door to the armory is locked; inside are three medium wooden shields, 3d6 spears, and two battle axes, all in excellent condition.

The hobgoblin chieftain's lair is at. He is wearing chainmail and a common (+1) bracer of shielding of dwarven manufacture, and wields a mace. He is wearing a non-magical dwarven signet ring worth 700 drac. The treasure alcove hidden in his room holds an uncommon elixir of health, two suits of chainmail, four swords, and a small locked treasure chest with 3d6 x 10 gold pieces and 3d6 x 10 silver.

Bloodhand Clan Lair

This is also directly above the kobold warrens. The secret room has a secret door leading from the Bloodhand chieftain's quarters, and another leading from the Blacktooth chief's quarters. Both leaders use this room to negotiate between their tribes and plan joint raids, whenever the two clans are not fighting each other.

The common room has 2d6 x 1hd redcap hunters each with shortswords and light wooden shields, along with 2d6 goblin young (1hd, will flee or hide rather than fighting).

The mess hall will have 2d6-2 x 1hd redcap hunters, each with light crossbows and light wooden shields.

The Blacktooth chieftain's lair always has a redcap hunter guard posted in the hallway outside, who actually takes their watch seriously. The room the guard is posted in also serves as the larder for the tribe; among the typical goblin offal is an actually high-quality cask of wine worth 55 drac.

The chieftain is a 3hd goblin redcap champion who wields a handaxe enchanted as a common (+1) flying blade, as well as a light steel shield. She is wearing banded armor originally intended for a dwarf, which is in slight need of repair. She is also adorned with various bits of expensive dwarven jewelry — a silver and gold belt worth 160 drac, an ivory bracelet worth 100 drac, and a gold and garnet signet ring worth 100 drac.

The room is well furnished with finely crafted dwarven furniture in slight disrepair, and contains a locked chest with 500 gold pieces inside.

Hobgoblin Chieftain (3 HD)

Doom 10+ Hold 10+ Blast 11+ Trick 13+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+	
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium
Armor: 2 (light +1)	HP: 3d6+12
Attacks (10+): mace (d6+2 blunt)	
Con +2 Str +2 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0	
Skills (5+): Agility, Stealth, Survival	
Feats: Boar Frenzy	

Hobgoblin Champion (2 HD) x16

Doom 11+ Hold 11+ Blast 12+ Trick 14+ Curse 13+ Fear 13+	
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium
Armor: 1 (light)	HP: 3d6+12
Attacks (11+): spear (d6+2 piercing, reach)	
Con +2 Str +2 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0	
Skills (5+): Agility, Survival	
Feats: Boar Frenzy	

Hobgoblin Hunter (2 HD) x12

Doom 11+ Hold 11+ Blast 12+ Trick 14+ Curse 13+ Fear 13+	
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium
Armor: 1 (light)	HP: 3d6+9
Attacks (11+): shortbow (d6 piercing / range 10)	
Con +2 Str +2 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0	
Skills (4+): Agility, Stealth, Perception, Survival	
Feats: Sneak Attack	

Redcap Chieftain (3 HD)

Doom 11+ Hold 12+ Blast 11+ Trick 13+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+	
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Small
Armor: 2 (light +1)	HP: (3d6+9) ÷2
Attacks (11+): +1 flying handaxe (d6+1 / range 5)	
Con +1 Str +0 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0	
Skills (5+): Agility, Stealth, Survival	
Feats: Boar Frenzy	

Redcap Hunter (1 HD) x20

Doom 13+ Hold 14+ Blast 13+ Trick 15+ Curse 14+ Fear 14+	
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Small
Armor: 1 (light)	HP: 4
Attacks (13+): light crossbow (d6 piercing / range 10)	
Con +1 Str +0 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0	
Skills (5+): Agility, Stealth, Perception, Survival	
Feats: Sneak Attack	

Wolf Beastfolk Lair

A group of clever wolf beastfolk have taken up residence in a small cavern in the far back of the ravine, near Crom Cruach's shrine. (They are related to the beastfolk camp to the south of the Keep — any non-pucca beastfolk that gets "too big for their britches" is sent here.) There is a small sign next to the cave's entrance, advertising for recruitment into their mercenary company in Albion, Eire, Imperial, draconic, and feytongue.

The first room to the left houses three 3hd wolf beastfolk champions who appear to be enjoying a good meal. There are three maces propped up against the table, and roast pheasant is cooking on a spit over an open fire. They will offer anyone who enters the cave some roast pheasant on a skewer, then suddenly attack with those skewers (which are actually disguised rapiers), usually catching their prey by surprise. There is a large warning-gong nearby, which one of them will use to alert the rest of the beastfolk tribe if they start losing the fight.

The chieftain and shaman's lair are up the stairs; the chieftain is a 3hd beastfolk champion wielding a greatsword, while his mate is a 4hd beastfolk druid. On display above their bed is a hand ax enchanted as a common (+1) flying blade, a large wooden treasure chest with two uncommon elixirs of health and 4d6 x 100 sp, and an alabaster-and-ivory statue of an elven dancer worth 200 drac. There is a secret door in this room which leads to the demon's labyrinth; if the fight is going poorly, the druid will attempt to cast an illusion to distract the party, and then both will attempt to escape and lure any pursuers into a confrontation with the demon. In the chieftain's pocket is a small brass key.

The larder is locked, normally requiring the chieftain's key to open. Inside is a rare (+3) mirror shield, being used as a cutting board for powdered haste potions (1d6+3 potions' worth of powder). There is also 400 drac worth of fine quality food and wine, and a flask of lamp oil.

The common room at the end of the other stairwell houses three 3hd beastfolk champions and five 2hd hunters. Next to it is a guard room, with two 3hd beastfolk champions and three 2hd beastfolk hunters guarding the slave pens in the next room.

To either side of the guard room are the slave pens. Within the first are two humans, two elves, and a dwarf; within the second is a scarred boar-faun and a single enormous human who seems half-mad from captivity. The inhabitants of each pen are chained to the wall with a common cold iron chain and a heavy padlock.

The two elves are a 1hd druid and a 2hd hunter; the dwarf is a 2hd delver. The human in the other cell is a 4 hd champion, and the hobgoblin next to him is a 3hd champion. Each prisoner has only half their maximum hit points, due to weeks of malnutrition, captivity, and torture. If freed and given weapons, they will all gladly help the party fight their way back out of the caves.

Once out, the human will seek to betray his liberators, kill them, and take all their treasure for himself; the hobgoblin, on the other hand, will sincerely ask for assistance in forswearing Crom Cruach and joining civilization, and the elves and dwarf will ask to be escorted back to the keep where they can recuperate.

Cullen (L4 Human Warrior)

Doom 9+ Hold 9+ Blast 11+ Trick 12+ Curse 11+ Fear 11+
Movement: 5 paces **Size:** Medium
Armor: 0 **HP:** 4d6+16
Attacks (9+): per weapon
Feats: Bear Frenzy
Con +2 Str +2 Dex +0 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0
Skills (4+): Agility, Stealth

Grnka (L3 Faun Champion)

Doom 11+ Hold 12+ Blast 12+ Trick 12+ Curse 11+ Fear 11+
Con +1 (11+) Str +0 (12+) Dex +0 (11+)
Int +0 (12+) Wis +0 (12+) Cha +0 (12+)
Movement: 5 paces **Size:** Medium
Armor: 0 **HP:** 3d6+9
Attacks (12+): per weapon
Feats: Boar Frenzy
Con +1 Str +0 Dex +0 Int +0 Wis +0 Cha +0
Skills (4+): Agility, Alertness

Owen (L2 Dwarf Delver)

Doom 12+ Hold 12+ Blast 13+ Trick 12+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+
Movement: 5 paces **Size:** Medium
Armor: 0 **HP:** 2d6+4
Attacks (12+): per weapon
Feats: Armored Stealth
Con +1 Str +1 Dex +0 Int +1 Wis +0 Cha +0
Skills (4+): Finesse, Science

Aislin (L2 Elf Hunter)

Doom 13+ Hold 14+ Blast 12+ Trick 13+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+
Movement: 5 paces **Size:** Medium
Armor: 0 **HP:** 2d6+2
Attacks (12+): per weapon
Feats: Sneak Attack
Con +0 Str -1 Dex +1 Int +0 Wis +1 Cha +0
Skills (4+): Stealth, Alertness, Survival

Seannad (L1 Elf Druid)

Doom 14+ Hold 15+ Blast 13+ Trick 14+ Curse 13+ Fear 14+
Movement: 5 paces **Size:** Medium
Armor: 0 **HP:** 6
Attacks (10+): per weapon
Con +0 Str -1 Dex +1 Int +0 Wis +1 Cha +0
Skills (5+): Agility, Intuition
Magic: none prepared (① available)

Wolf-Faun Druid (L4 Druid)

Doom 11+ Hold 10+ Blast 11+ Trick 11+ Curse 11+ Fear 11+
Movement: 5 paces **Size:** Medium
Armor: 3 (thornweave) **HP:** 4d6
Attacks (10+): quarterstaff (2d6)
Con +0 Str +1 Dex +0 Int +0 Wis +0 Cha +0
Skills (4+): Intuition, Survival

Wolf-Faun Chieftan (L3 Champion)

Doom 12+ Hold 10+ Blast 11+ Trick 13+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+
Movement: 5 paces **Size:** Medium
Armor: 2 (light +1) **HP:** 3d6+6
Attacks (10+): Greatsword (2d6+2)
Feats: Wolf Frenzy
Con +0 Str +2 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0
Skills (4+): Agility, Alertness

Wolf-Faun Guards (L3 Champion) x 3

Doom 12+ Hold 10+ Blast 11+ Trick 13+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+
Movement: 5 paces **Size:** Medium
Armor: 1 (light) **HP:** 3d6+6
Attacks (10+): Rapier (1d6+2 piercing)
Feats: Wolf Frenzy
Con +0 Str +2 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0
Skills (4+): Agility, Alertness

Wolf-Faun Champions (Level 3) x 5

Doom 12+ Hold 10+ Blast 11+ Trick 13+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+
Movement: 5 paces **Size:** Medium
Armor: 1 (light) **HP:** 2d6+4
Attacks (10+): Greatsword (2d6+1)
Feats: Wolf Frenzy
Con +0 Str +2 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0
Skills (4+): Agility, Stealth, Perception, Survival

Wolf-Faun Hunters (Level 2) x 8

Doom 13+ Hold 12+ Blast 11+ Trick 14+ Curse 13+ Fear 13+
Con +0 (13+) Str +1 (12+) Dex +1 (12+)
Int +0 (13+) Wis +0 (13+) Cha +0 (13+)
Movement: 5 paces **Size:** Medium
Armor: 1 (light) **HP:** 2d6+2
Attacks (11+): Two daggers (2d6 piercing)
Feats: Sneak Attack
Con +0 Str +1 Dex +2 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0
Skills (4+): Agility, Stealth, Alertness, Survival

Hobgoblin Chieftain (3 HD)

Doom 10+ Hold 10+ Blast 11+ Trick 13+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+
Movement: 5 paces **Size:** Medium
Armor: 3 (medium +1) **HP:** 3d6+12
Attacks (10+): mace (d6+2 blunt)
Con +2 Str +2 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0
Skills (5+): Agility, Stealth, Survival
Feats: Boar Frenzy

Bugbear Champion (4 HD)

Doom 8+ Hold 8+ Blast 10+ Trick 12+ Curse 11+ Fear 11+
Movement: 5 paces **Size:** Large
Armor: 2 (light +1) **HP:** (4d6+20)x2
Attacks (8+): oversized greatsword (3d6+3)
Feats: Bear Frenzy
Con +3 Str +3 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0
Skills (5+): Agility, Stealth, Survival, Leadership

Hobgoblin Champion (2 HD) x16

Doom 11+ Hold 11+ Blast 12+ Trick 14+ Curse 13+ Fear 13+
Movement: 5 paces **Size:** Medium
Armor: 2 (medium) **HP:** 3d6+12
Attacks (11+): spear (d6+2 piercing, reach)
Con +2 Str +2 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0
Skills (5+): Agility, Survival
Feats: Boar Frenzy

Hobgoblin Jailer (3 HD)

Doom 10+ Hold 10+ Blast 11+ Trick 13+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+
Movement: 5 paces **Size:** Medium
Armor: 3 (thornweave) **HP:** 3d6+12
Attacks (10+): whip (d6, reach 2)
Feats: Bear Frenzy
Con +2 Str +2 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0
Skills (4+): Finesse, Stealth

Hobgoblin Hunter (2 HD) x12

Doom 11+ Hold 11+ Blast 12+ Trick 14+ Curse 13+ Fear 13+
Movement: 5 paces **Size:** Medium
Armor: 1 (light) **HP:** 3d6+9
Attacks (11+): shortbow (d6 piercing / range 10)
Con +2 Str +2 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0
Skills (4+): Agility, Stealth, Perception, Survival
Feats: Sneak Attack

Hobgoblin Jail Guard (3 HD)

Doom 10+ Hold 10+ Blast 11+ Trick 13+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+
Movement: 5 paces **Size:** Medium
Armor: 3 (thornweave) **HP:** 3d6+12
Attacks (10+): shortsword (d6)
Feats: Bear Frenzy
Con +2 Str +2 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0
Skills (4+): Stealth, Alertness

Redcap Chieftain (3 HD)

Doom 11+ Hold 12+ Blast 11+ Trick 13+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+
Movement: 5 paces **Size:** Small
Armor: 2 (light +1) **HP:** (3d6+9) ÷2
Attacks (11+): +1 flying handaxe (d6+1 / range 5)
Con +1 Str +0 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0
Skills (5+): Agility, Stealth, Survival
Feats: Boar Frenzy

Hobgoblin Champion (3 HD) x 3d6

Doom 10+ Hold 10+ Blast 11+ Trick 13+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+
Movement: 5 paces **Size:** Medium
Armor: 2 (light +1) **HP:** 3d6+12
Attacks (10+): greataxe (2d6+2, sundering)
Feats: Bear Frenzy
Con +2 Str +2 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0
Skills (4+): Agility, Bearing

Redcap Hunter (1 HD) x20

Doom 13+ Hold 14+ Blast 13+ Trick 15+ Curse 14+ Fear 14+
Movement: 5 paces **Size:** Small
Armor: 1 (light) **HP:** 4
Attacks (13+): light crossbow (d6 piercing / range 10)
Con +1 Str +0 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0
Skills (5+): Agility, Stealth, Perception, Survival
Feats: Sneak Attack

Hobgoblin Hunter (3 HD) x 4d6 + 4

Doom 10+ Hold 10+ Blast 11+ Trick 13+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+
Movement: 5 paces **Size:** Medium
Armor: 1 / 0 (leather) **HP:** 3d6+9
Attacks (10+): shortbow (d6 / range 10), dagger (d6 piercing)
Feats: Sneak Attack
Con +2 Str +2 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0
Skills (4+): Agility, Stealth, Perception, Survival

Skitterglint Warrens

The third goblin clan's nest is across the ravine from the kobold lair, on the right side at ground level. At the actual ground level are the redcap warrens, where young goblins of the Skitterglint clan are mostly left to fend for themselves.

There is an alcove directly across from the entrance, which has a leather draped over it. The rawhide has been crudely painted to resemble the cave walls; an Alertness check will spot it on the way in. Behind the entrance are 15 x 2hd redcap hunters in three ranks - the first rank is laying down, the second rank is kneeling, and the third rank is standing. Each is wearing leather and wielding a light crossbow, all pointed at the entrance and prepared to fire. In front of them, also behind the drapery, is an enormous 8' sphere of refuse and dried goblin sewage, with a stone in front of it to hold it in place and a single goblin ready to pull out the stone and let the giant, foul-smelling ball roll out the entrance and flatten whoever might be coming in uninvited. (Yes, this will also flatten the goblin that pulls the stone out of the way.)

There are two guard chambers, each staffed by 6 x 2hd redcap champions. Each redcap has a stack of javelins that they are ready to throw at intruders. One chamber has a secret door into their ogre chieftain's lair; if the goblins decide it is worth the risk, they will ask the chieftain for help in repelling the invaders.

Redcap Chieftain (3 HD)

Doom 11+ Hold 12+ Blast 11+ Trick 13+ Curse 12+ Fear 12+	
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Small
Armor: 2 (light +1)	HP: (3d6+9) ÷2
Attacks (11+): spear (2d6, reach)	
Feats: Snake Frenzy	
Con +1 Str +0 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0	
Skills (4+): Stealth, Alertness	

Redcap Champion (2 HD) x 4d6 + 6

Doom 12+ Hold 13+ Blast 12+ Trick 14+ Curse 13+ Fear 13+	
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Small
Armor: 2 (light +1)	HP: (2d6+4) ÷2
Attacks (13+): javelin (d6 piercing / range 5)	
Feats: Snake Frenzy	
Con +1 Str +0 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0	
Skills (4+): Stealth, Alertness	

The common room is staffed by 4d6 x 2hd redcap champions, 4d6 x 2hd redcap hunters, and two 1hd redcap druids.

The Skitterglints have two "sub-chieftains", who handle actual day-to-day leadership while their "ur-chief" ogre focuses on filling his belly with meat. The redcap sub-chieftain's chambers are beyond the common room to the left; he is a 3hd champion, accompanied by a harem of two 2hd redcap hunters, three non-combatant female goblins (1hd each, will flee or hide rather than fight), and one very traumatized gnome who continues to insist that he is neither goblin, nor female, nor interested (1hd non-combatant, will beg to join the party and be escorted out).

The redcap's larder is beyond the common room to the right, with four 2hd redcap hunters with crossbows positioned in an alcove hidden behind another painted leather drape to guard it. Nothing in the larder is of particular value to anyone but a goblin. There is a hidden secret door into the hobgoblin's caves in the back of the larder, which the hobgoblins of the clan has been using to raid the redcaps' stores; each exploration round that the party lingers in this room beyond the first, there is a 1-in-6 chance that 1d6 x 3hd hobgoblin hunters will appear, hoping to raid the pantry.

Redcap Hunter (1 HD) x 4d6 + 21

Doom 13+ Hold 14+ Blast 13+ Trick 15+ Curse 14+ Fear 14+	
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Small
Armor: 1 (light)	HP: 4
Attacks (13+): crossbow (d6+1 piercing / range 15)	
Feats: Sneak Attack	
Con +1 Str +0 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0	
Skills (4+): Stealth	

Redcap Druid (1 HD) x 2

Doom 13+ Hold 14+ Blast 13+ Trick 15+ Curse 14+ Fear 14+	
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Small
Armor: 2 (light +1)	HP: 4
Attacks (13+): quarterstaff (2d6 blunt)	
Con +1 Str +0 Dex +1 Int -1 Wis +0 Cha +0	
Skills (4+): Stealth	

Skitterglint Hobgoblin Lair

The hobgoblins of the Skitterglint clan reside above the ogre cave, in what they call the “luxury suites”.

The first room on the left is a combination pantry and torture chamber. Two 3hd hobgoblin champions are here, each wearing a +1 thornweave hide armor and wielding a shortsword and a light wooden shield. One also has a whip, and is reasonably practiced at using it for combat stunts (Finesse 4+). The other is wearing an expensive but non-magical silver and sapphire amulet, worth 135 drac.

There are four prisoners here:

- An overweight merchant from the keep, being fattened up to serve as the main course for tonight’s banquet. If he can be rescued, the keep will offer a 3d6 x 10 drac reward and honorary guild membership.
- The merchant’s wife, who is also being prepared as tonight’s appetizer. If brought back to the keep, she will reward the adventurers with a common (+1) keen blade enchanted dagger.
- Two 1hd human warriors, who were the merchant’s bodyguards. If rescued, they will offer their services to the party.

Human Merchant (1 HD)

All Saves: 15+			
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium	HP: 6	

Merchant’s Wife (1 HD)

All Saves: 15+			
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium	HP: 6	

Human Warrior (1 HD)

Doom: 14+ Hold 13+ Blast 14+ Trick 14+ Curse 14+ Fear 14+			
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium		
Armor: 0	HP: 8		
Attacks (13+): per weapon			

The common room at the far left also leads down into the redcap warrens, with 1d6 x 3hd hobgoblin champions and 2d6 x 3hd hunters. Each champion will have a greataxe, while each hunter will wield a pair of shortswor-

ds. Straight ahead from the entrance is the hobgoblins’ common room. This is where meals, celebrations, and other gatherings occur, and also serves as their sleeping quarters. It is very, very messy and unkempt. There are 1d6 x 3hd hobgoblin champions here, 1d6 x 3hd hobgoblin hunters, and (1d6+3) young goblins (1hd each, will hide or flee rather than fight). The room is currently in the process of being laid out with tables, chairs, and silverware for a feast (the merchant and his wife). The silverware in particular is of fine dwarven make, worth 25 drac.

To the right of the entrance is a guardroom with 1d6 x 3hd hobgoblins champions with greataxes, and 1d6 x 3hd hunters with shortbows and two daggers. Beyond it, the hobgoblin’s armory contains two suits of plate armor (one sized for humans, the other for dwarves), five suits of chainmail, seven suits of leather armor, eleven light wooden shields, six daggers, one battle ax, four maces, two shortswor-

ds, one longsword, two shortbows, one longbow, thirteen crossbows, 130 arrows, 72 crossbow bolts, 50 javelins, 19 glaives, and 42 helmets of various sizes. Like the redcaps, the hobgoblins have a “sub-chieftain” who calls the shots — a 4hd bugbear champion holed up behind a secret door from the armory, with a harem of four 3hd hobgoblin hunters. The chieftain wields a greatsword too large for a medium creature, and has a dwarven belt adorned with rubies worth 600 drac. Hidden in the kindling of the fireplace is an uncommon (+2) magic wand enchanted with the hold person spell. There is an iron treasure chest in one corner of the room filled with rotting animal hides; it has a false bottom, below which is 3d6 x 100 drakhma coins, a 100 drac emerald, and a potion of uncommon (-2) intelligence-sapping poison.

Across a hallway from the sub-chieftan's lair is a larder where the supplies stolen from the redcaps are stored. There is nothing valuable to the party here; all of the food is goblin fare and thus highly suspect. The hallway also branches off into a smaller hallway, at the end of which is a secret passageway into the redcaps’ larder; the passageway is obvious from this side.

Ogre's Cave

This cavern has a noticeably larger opening than the others. The Skitterglint clan's chieftain lives here – a vast ogre grown fat on the blood and bones of Albians and Eirish alike. The middle of the cave contains a vast bed made from straw and bear-hides; the ogre himself will usually be sitting in the back of the cave. A secret door leads into his chambers; the Skitterglint redcaps will come to ask him for help only if they find they can't handle the adventurers themselves, as he is known to devour any underlings that disturb him without cause.

The ogre chieftain wears stitched-together bearskin hides as armor (armor 2/0) and an uncommon (+2) belt of feral might as an armband, and he wields a +3 earthbreaker warhammer. He is a 6 hd huge creature, and as such is quite possibly the most formidable threat the party could face aside from the baal-malak demon in the labyrinth.

Hidden under his bearskin bedsheets are a series of leather sacks containing a +1 quiver of elemental bolts, a keg of brandy worth 80 drac, 3d6 x 100 copper pennies, 3d6 x 100 silver dimes, 3d6 x 100 gold drakhma, and another 3d6 x 100 counterfeit gold drakhma (actually lead alloy plated with gold).

While the ogre is officially the “ur-chief” over the Skitterglint clan, he mostly sits in his cave and demands to be brought elves, dwarves, and hobs to feast on. When he cannot sate his ravenous hunger, he often turns on his own subjects and allies, consuming roughly two goblins, beastfolk, or lizardfolk per week.

Adventure Note — If the party can bring back sufficient proof of the ogre's existence to Sir Edward, or if the party manages to antagonize the ogre sufficiently that it chases them back to the Keep, Sir Edward will don the Siege Perilous and come fight it himself. If the party contains a Wizard or Dweomersmith, they will likely be asked to take the Engineer's seat and assist him in the battle; the rest of the party will be given a dozen guards to help clear out any goblins or other creatures that decide to join the fray.

Ogre (6 HD Huge Creature)

Doom 5+ Hold 5+ Blast 11+ Trick 12+ Curse 9+ Fear 9+
Movement: 5 paces **Size:** Huge 3
Armor: 2 / 0 (hide) **HP:** [3d6+12]
Attacks (2+): earthbreaker maul (3d6+12 structure, reach 2)
Con +4 Str +6 Dex -2 Int -3 Wis +0 Cha +0
Skills (3+): Perception, Survival
Senses: Smell (superior) - Ogres automatically succeed on any attempt to smell blood, and can smell freshly-spilt demihuman blood from a distance of nearly a mile.

Huge Size: An ogre's hit points are split between multiple body sections. When the the ogre is hit by an attack that wasn't easy, the attacker must roll 2d6 and consult the following chart:

3-4	Left Leg	1x [hp]
5	Left Arm	1x [hp]
6-8	Body	4x [hp]
9	Right Arm	1x [hp]
10-11	Right Leg	1x [hp]
12, 12*	Head	½ [hp]

***Duck:** The ogre can use its reaction to force an attack that hits its head to re-roll another location; any hit point damage to its head stuns it.

Cripple: A critical hit to any location reduces that location to 0 hp; reducing the head or body to 0 hp kills the ogre, while reducing the legs to 0 hp hobbles it, and reducing an arm to 0 hp makes all attacks harder when not using its reckless attack.

Frenzy: Whenever any location is reduced to 0 damage, the ogre regains all rage, and can then immediately spend its reaction to make a sweep attack:

Sweep Attack: The ogre has three rage. It can spend one rage as its action to swing its weapon in a wide arc, hitting every creature within 3 paces of it; each creature may either save vs. blast or save vs. knockdown for half damage. Any creature that fails to save is knocked prone and flung 1d6 paces away.

Boar Beastfolk Lair

Between the labyrinth and shrine, a barbarian tribe of boar faun beastfolk have taken up residence. They are bitter enemies of the wolf beastfolk across the grotto; the acolytes in the shrine have their hands full keeping the two tribes from going at each other's throats.

The guard room always has two 3hd beastfolk champions and two 2hd beastfolk hunters on duty. Each hunter is wearing leather and armed with a longbow; each champion is wearing boar hides and armed with a greataxe. Each is wearing d6 x 10 drac worth of gold jewelry, mostly as piercing rings. When the encounter begins, each hunter will fire their bow at intruders while the champions charge into melee; then the hunters will dash back into the corridor to alert the rest of the tribe.

The second guard chamber houses another 1d6+2 x 3hd beastfolk champions and 1d6+1 x 2hd beastfolk hunters, ready to aid the guards at (1) when summoned.

The beastfolk armory is locked; inside are one suit of dwarven chainmail, seven round wooden medium shields, three longbows, twelve greataxes, and an uncommon (+2) keen longsword which is cursed — whenever it misses, it immediately inflicts a critical hit upon its wielder, lopping off a limb.

The common room serves as the tribe's living and sleeping space. There are 2d6 x 3hd champions and 2d6+1 x 2hd hunters quartered here, along with 4d6 children (1hd each, will flee or hide rather than fighting).

In the furthest reaches of these caves is the chieftain's quarters. He is a 4hd champion wielding a greataxe. With him are his four wives (two 2hd hunters, one 3hd champion, and one 4hd druid), and his two sons (one a 2hd hunter, one a 2hd champion). The druidess has an uncommon wood pearl focus fashioned into an amulet.

In the back is a well-hidden secret doorway, requiring a hard Alertness check to notice even if you are right up against it, but the chieftain or his wives might reveal it if interrogated. Behind this doorway is a passage into the Temple of Crom-Cruach, which the beastfolk use to transfer prisoners.

Boar-Faun Chieftain (4 HD)

Str +0 (11+)	Dex +0 (11+)	Con +1 (10+)
Int +0 (11+)	Wis +0 (11+)	Cha +0 (11+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium	
Armor: 2 (I)	HP: 4d6+12	
Attacks (11+): greataxe (2d6 rending)		
Skills (4+): Agility, Perception		
Feats: Boar Frenzy		

Boar-Faun Druid (4 HD)

Str +0 (11+)	Dex +0 (11+)	Con +1 (10+)
Int +0 (11+)	Wis +0 (11+)	Cha +0 (11+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium	
Armor: 2 (I)	HP: 4d6+12	
Attacks (11+): per weapon		
Skills (4+): Agility, Perception		
Magic: 4 glamour, + one second-circle wood effect		

Boar-Faun Champion (3 HD) x 3d6 + 5

Str +0 (12+)	Dex +0 (12+)	Con +1 (11+)
Int +0 (12+)	Wis +0 (12+)	Cha +0 (12+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium	
Armor: 2 (I)	HP: 3d6+9	
Attacks (12+): greataxe (2d6 rending)		
Skills (5+): Agility, Perception, Survival		
Feats: Boar Frenzy		

Boar-Faun Hunter (2 HD) x 3d6 + 6

Str +0 (13+)	Dex +0 (13+)	Con +1 (12+)
Int +0 (13+)	Wis +0 (13+)	Cha +0 (13+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium	
Armor: 1 (0)	HP: 2d6+4	
Attacks (13+): longbow (2d6 / range 15)		
Skills (5+): Agility, Stealth, Perception, Survival		
Feats: Sneak Attack		

Ursagryph's Lair

There is a smaller cavern deep in the ravine that the goblins and kobolds haven't bothered to clear out, because it is the home of both a gelatinous ooze and a ferocious ursagryph.

There is a still pool of water containing a small population of blind white cave-fish. Laying in the pool is a jewel-encrusted gold cup worth 1300 drac. Gripping the walls and ceiling above the pool is a gelatinous ooze; when the water of the pool is disturbed, the ooze will retract from its perch, cover the entrance, and wait for the party to stumble into it so it can feast upon them. In the dark, the ooze simply looks like a slick, wet coating on the cavern walls until it begins moving; even then, noticing its movement is hard.

Each of the small alcoves is a dumping-ground for the remains of the ursagryph's victims. Searching each of these spaces might result in a few coins or other small low-value treasure. Searching is likely to attract the attention of the cavern's inhabitants; roll a d6 for each exploration round spent searching:

1	Ursagryph
2	2d6 Giant Rats
3	Ooze
4-6	No Encounter

The ursagryph itself lairs deep in the furthest recesses of the cave. The creature is used to being harassed by goblins and kobolds, and so is naturally hostile towards any creature that approaches it. On a d6 roll of 1-3, the ursagryph is guarding a nest with that many ursagryph eggs.

Ursagryph (5 HD)

Con +3	(7+)	Str +3	(7+)	Dex +1	(9+)
Int -4	(14+)	Wis +1	(9+)	Cha +1	(9+)
Movement:	Fly		Size:	Large	
Armor:	1 (0)		HP:	(5d6+15)x2	
Attacks (8+ x2): bite (2d6+3 piercing), claws (3d6+3 blunt)					
Skills (3+): Agility, Stealth, Perception, Survival					
Senses: Sight (superior), Hearing (superior)					
Behavior: always aggressive					

Frenzy: An ursagryph will not retreat if it is wounded, instead gaining +2d6 damage to each of its attacks until subdued if it is below half its maximum hit points.

Gelatinous Ooze (6 HD)

Doom 5+ Hold 5+ Blast 11+ Trick — Curse — Fear —											
Movement: 1 pace				Size: Large							
Armor: 3 (vulnerable cold)				HP: 5d6+25							
Attacks (5+): engulf (grapple), dissolve (3d6 acid)											
Con +4		Str +4		Dex -2		Int —		Wis —		Cha —	
Skills (2+): Stealth											

Harvesting: An ooze's gelatinous remains can be alchemically processed to render 5d6 charges of water materia.

Paralyzing Mucus: Any creature grappled by the ooze suffers acid damage from a full dissolve attack at the beginning of their turn, and must save vs. paralysis or be rendered helpless for that turn. Any creature that succeeds is hobbled.

Digestion: Any acid damage dealt to a living creature by the ooze also heals the ooze for that many hit points. If this increases the ooze above its current maximum hit points, it immediately gains additional hit dice until it can accommodate its new hit point total.

Mitosis: A large ooze that is reduced to below half its hit points by weapon damage splits into two medium-sized oozes, each with half the original creature's starting hit points; a medium ooze splits into two small oozes, and a small ooze splits into two tiny oozes.

Giant Rat (1hd) x 2d6

Doom 16+ Hold 16+ Blast 13+ Trick 17+ Curse 13+ Fear 15+											
Movement: Fast				Size: Small							
Armor: 0				HP: 2							
Attacks (15+):bite (d6 piercing, diseased)											
Con -2 Str -2 Dex +1 Int -4 Wis +1 Cha -1											
Skills (3+): Agility, Stealth, Alertness, Survival											
Senses: Smell (superior)											
Behavior (d6): 1-2 fearful, 3-5 wary,6 aggressive											

Raising a Baby Ursagryph

A druid or hunter that can perform the Beast Bond ritual is obviously going to want to try to raise a pet ursagryph, if there are any eggs available. Getting eggs to hatch will take 1d6 weeks of regular attention; each week requires a Survival check for each egg from whoever is tending to them, to keep that egg alive.

A newly-hatched ursagryph is a 1 hd small creature, and will be voraciously hungry for meat; after three months of growth, it will be a 2hd medium creature, and after six, it will be a 3hd large creature. It then gains 1hd per season until it is full-grown at one year of age.

The Demon's Labyrinth

This naturally formed maze of tunnels is the original wellspring of power that the shrine was built around in antiquity.

Trapped within these twisted passages is an avatar of Crom Cruach itself — an ancient Baal-Malak demon cursed and trapped within the cavern. It has languished without worshippers for thousands of years, and so is incredibly weak — reduced from 10hd to 6hd.

Even so, it is an incredibly dangerous foe; encountering it before destroying the shrine and severing its connection to its worshippers is effectively suicide, and even after the shrine is destroyed, the creature is likely to be considerably stronger than the entire adventuring party. Each member of the party needs to make a hard save vs. fear upon encountering the demon; those who fail are shaken (all their attack rolls will be harder).

A nest of 3d6 bloodstirges is near the entrance at (1), and a nest of six fire beetles moves between (2) and (3), each of which are likely to ambush the party if they explore in those directions or are chased into them by the demon — who is usually sulking in its own lair at (4) unless a noise alerts it to visitors. Behind (5) is a well-hidden secret door that leads to the wolfkin chieftain's lair.

In the back of the demon's lair is the original shrine that summoned it; a set of locked drawers built into the shrine will reveal a small treasure horde that was originally owned by a pagan hero of Crom Cruach in long-forgotten antiquity.

- The first drawer is locked and trapped with a poison needle; if successfully opened, it contains 3d6 x 1000 drac worth of gold coins that predate the Old Empire, as well as three expensive pieces of jewelry worth approximately 1600, 900, and 300 drac respectively.
- The second drawer contains a staff of healing and an orichalc plate of a truly ancient (Aztlantean) design.
- The third drawer is locked, but not trapped; it contains an elixir of regeneration, a love potion, and a tempest in a bottle — all of which are still good, even after thousands of years.

Adventure Note — Like the ogre, the demon represents a sufficient threat that Sir Edward might be roused to attend to the matter personally. The demon cannot leave its cave yet, and the Siege Perilous will not fit inside, so Sir Edward would likely ask the party to lead him to the cave and help with the assault. As before, Sir Edward would need sufficient proof of the danger to do so.

Even with the temple eradicated and Sir Edward leading the charge, a direct assault on the demon is likely to be an incredibly difficult battle. Destroying the altars in Crom Cruach's temple, and then performing the hallow ritual on each room as a group with all the other priests from the keep's abbey, might further reduce the Baal-malak's power from 6 hd to 4 hd. This would reduce its SP to 2D6+10, reducing its abilities to +4 and raising its saving throws from 5+ to 7+.

Bloodstirge (1 HD)

Con -2 (16+)	Str -3 (17+)	Dex +3 (11+)
Int -4 (17+)	Wis +0 (14+)	Cha -4 (17+)
Movement: Fly	Size: Tiny	
Armor: 0	HP: 1	
Attacks (11+): latch on (grapple), bite (1 hp)		
Skills (2+): Agility, Stealth, Perception		
Senses: Can sense warm-blooded creatures from up to 10 paces away		

Drain Blood - A bloodstirge that latches onto a victim stays attached for 1d6 combat rounds. Each round, the victim must make a save vs. disease or suffer a cumulative -1 penalty to Constitution (reducing hit points and maximum hit points accordingly); if Constitution would be reduced below -4, instead treat the damage as a critical hit.

Lost Constitution heals at 1 point per day, or can be healed immediately with a restoration miracle; until it is healed, the afflicted creature cannot heal hit point damage through rest.

Disease Carrier - A creature bitten by a bloodstirge that achieves a critical hit, or a creature with a stirge latched onto it when that stirge is killed, must make a saving throw vs. disease or contract a nasty blood borne infection.

Fire Beetle (3 HD)

Con +2 (10+)	Str +0 (12+)	Dex +0 (12+)
Int -4 (16+)	Wis +0 (12+)	Cha -4 (16+)
Movement: Slow, Fly Slow	Size: Small	
Armor: 3	HP: (3d6+6)+2	
Attacks (11+): bite (1d6+2 hp)		
Skills (5+): None		

Harvesting - If properly harvested, a fire beetle yields 2d6 charges of flame materia.

Bioluminescence - A fire beetle's lightspots produce bright light out to 2 paces, and dim light out to 5 paces.

Flamethrower - A fire beetle has two points of glamour, which it can use to generate a 4-pace cone of flame in front of it that inflicts 2d6 fire damage.

Baal-malak (6 HD)

Con +5 (5+)	Str +5 (5+)	Dex +5 (5+)
Int +5 (5+)	Wis +5 (5+)	Cha +5 (5+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Large	
Armor: *(aetheric form)	SP: 306+15	
Attacks (5+): longsword (1D6+5 fire structure damage), (2/turn) whip (1D6 lightning structure damage)		
Skills (2+): Arcana, Medicine, Lore, Charm, Leadership, Wit		
Magic: cause fear, true strike, divine censure, smite, infernal champion		

Divine Vulnerability - The baal-malak suffers full damage from any divine magic; divine attacks that would normally deal hit point damage instead inflict that much structure damage to it.

Spirit Form - A baal-malak is immune to poison, disease, and critical hits. When its hit points are reduced to zero, it is banished, and cannot be summoned again for one lunar month. A baal-malak's armor and weapons are an innate part of its form, and disappear if it is banished. It can grant a loyal demihuman the use of one or both of its weapons on "loan", and can change the size of its weapons to fit whoever it bestows them to. They still inflict structure damage even when shrunk to fit in a mortal's hand.

Cultists - A warlock priest may perform a blood sacrifice within the shrine, wounding itself or any restrained demihuman captive with its ceremonial dagger to heal the baal-malak for 1D6 structure points or restore one miracle. If a ritually-prepared victim is sacrificed there (represented by a '19' or '20' roll on the "Keeping The Adventure Alive" chart), the Baal-Malak permanently gains two hit dice - increasing its maximum structure points by +1d6+5.

The Shrine of Crom-Cruach

This is an ancient temple of worship dedicated to Crom Cruach, which is feeding power to the demon within the labyrinth in the hopes of freeing it and using it to crush the Albians for good.

Near the entrance is a collapsed tunnel filled with boulders; clearing it would take at least a hundred man-hours of labor. The tunnel leads to a hidden druid grove south of the caves.

The first room is a grisly sight, with an ornate throne surrounded by twelve skeletons in chainmail. The throne is decorated with four blood-red rubies, each worth approximately 500 drac.

Each skeleton has a medium shield and a shortsword, all in poor repair (-1 to parry and damage). They are not animated upon entering the chamber, but touching the throne will release a glyph of warding that animates them. Each animates as a 1hd skeleton, and each is wearing an agate amulet displaying the holy symbol of Crom Cruach, which grants each of them a 12+ saving throw vs. rebuke the unholy.

The next room is filled with eight 2hd shamblers, who will attack anyone not wearing an amulet displaying the holy symbol of Crom Cruach. The shamblers are themselves wearing such amulets, which grant each of them a 12+ saving throw vs. rebuke the unholy, as above.

The acolyte's chamber houses three human acolytes of Crom Cruach's cult (treat as a 1hd death domain priests), and one adept (treat as a 3hd death domain priest). Each has cause fear prepared, and the adept also has command prepared.

There is a devotional chapel, where the acolytes perform rituals to honor Crom Cruach, or to grant dark blessings to the goblins, beastfolk and lizardfolk that have come to serve them. The floor is a black-and-red marble checkerboard, and there is a grisly tapestry mural to Crom Cruach hanging on the far wall. There are expensive, finely wrought implements of sacrifice on the altar — a gold-alloy sickle, four iron spikes inlaid with silver and ivory, and a large gold bowl for collecting blood — but each radiates an aura of palpable evil.

The adept's chamber houses four human adepts of Crom Cruach's cult (treat as 3hd death domain priests). As before, each has cause fear and command prepared.

Next is a ready-room where an undead army is being prepared, to raid the keep. Twenty 1hd skeletons and twenty 1hd shamblers are here, outfitted as before.

Finally, there is the temple proper, where dark rites to Crom Cruach feed the demon in the labyrinth. The floor here is polished black obsidian, shot through with veins of a translucent blood-red stone. The western wall is a solid piece of the same red stone, which has also been polished to a mirror shine. Dim light and moving shadows can be seen through the translucent wall, but clear shapes can't be made out.

There is a black wrought-iron bell and hammer at the entrance to the room, etched with swirling pagan runes. Towards the back of the room is a raised dais, on which is a circle of twelve standing stones of near-black basalt; in the middle of these is a gilded basalt stone crudely carved to vaguely suggest the form of a hunched over, wizened man. In front of this gilded stone are three translucent black obsidian altars, with flow channels to direct blood into the translucent red stone veins in the floor.

The entrance to high priest's chamber is well-hidden behind the tapestries, with an additional hidden passageway leading back to the main hallway. The high priest is a 5th level warlock of the death domain, wearing mithral chainmail and a flying shield while wielding a staff of suggestion quarterstaff. If cornered, he also has a legendary aetheric dagger which he can use to cut open a hole into the underworld to escape any fight that he feels he is losing. He has curse ability, heal minor wounds, and divine rebuke prepared, as well as two scrolls of cause fear and one scroll of divine censure. He has 3d6 x 50 drac, and a gold ring with a black star sapphire gem worth 1400 drac.

The first room of the lower chambers is a well-furnished torture chamber. The torturer is a 3hd human warrior wearing black chainmail and wielding a greataxe. Next to the torture chamber are the torturer's private quarters. It has a comfortable bed and furnishings, but contains nothing of value to the party.

The storage chamber at the far end of the hall has nothing of value, but if the party lingers for more than one exploration round, they will awaken a gelatinous ooze that the cultists use to guard the area.

The prison cells on the right contain several corpses, and one living, beautiful, and naked woman who will beg to be set free and taken back to the keep. She is actually a lilin (a 5 hd baalim demon), and hopes to corrupt others into Crom's service once she is "home".

The door to the crypts is bolted shut; behind it is a barrow-crypt, with sarcophagi entombing the first worshippers of Crom Cruach who built this temple. If the tombs are opened, one of the corpses will animate as a 3hd revenant after one exploration round, and attack the party for disturbing their rest. The revenant is wearing mithril chainmail and wielding an uncommon (+2) frostbrand longsword.

The revenant's tomb has a secret compartment that can be found with a thorough search; within it is a cursed crown of command which slowly corrupts the wearer until his personality is overtaken by the revenant's, and a silver dagger with inset rubies worth 800 drac.

Adventure Note — An active shrine to Crom Cruach where human sacrifices are being performed is a bigger threat than even the demon or the ogre, because it represents a rallying point for all the dark forces of the island. If the party manages to find their way into the shrine, confirm that an undead army is being raised and sacrifices are being made by the priests, and return with this news to Sir Edward, he will waste no time in mounting a full-out assault on the area with all available forces.

The priests at the abbey will also join, since this kind of work will require active protection against the supernatural; once the work is done, the priests will have their hands full for at least a year cleansing the caves of evil and consecrating the ground. This will eventually uncover the secret passageway to the druid's grove; once the grove is found, Dame MacGerald will attempt to reclaim it and resume worship. She will ask for the party's help only if there are any druids, hunters, champions, or nature priests among the player characters.

Cleansing the caves of evil and restoring the druid's grove will lead to the establishment of a small monastery, using the cave system as living quarters and claiming the shrine itself as a place of worship. The referee is encouraged to allow the player characters to set up a permanent base of operations at the keep, with the druid's grove and the monastery as secondary places of refuge.

From here, the party can venture westward beyond the Pale, or aid Sir Edward in clearing out the beastfolk camp, lizardfolk barrow, ettercap nest, and other minor threats that might still linger in the area; once the space is secure, settlers will begin arriving from Albion to start clearing some of the forest to make way for farmland and villages.

Fully exploring the area, clearing all threats, and defeating the shrine might take anywhere from five to twelve sessions of play; at the end of this adventure, the party should be squarely at level 3, or possibly as high as level four or five if there were few deaths and a good amount of clever problem-solving. If the party chooses to continue westward and southward, you can use the random map generation procedures in the Referee's Guide appendices to fill out as much space as you wish, or try converting some old B/X adventures and adapting their storylines to fit wild adventures through faerie.

Good luck!

High Priest (5 HD)

Con +0 (10+)	Str +0 (10+)	Dex +0 (10+)
Int +0 (10+)	Wis +0 (10+)	Cha +2 (8+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium	
Armor: 3 / 2	HP: 5d6	
Attacks (10+): quarterstaff (2d6 blunt)		
Skills (3+): Lore, Intuition, Bearing, Wit		
Magic: curse ability, heal minor wounds, infernal rebuke		
+from items: cause fear x2 (scrolls)		
divine censure (scroll)		
suggestion (staff)		

Torturer (3 HD)

Con +0 (12+)	Str +1 (11+)	Dex +0 (12+)
Int +0 (12+)	Wis +0 (12+)	Cha +0 (12+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium	
Armor: 2 / 1	HP: 3d6+6	
Attacks (11+): greataxe (2d6+1, sundering)		
Skills (5+): Stealth, Medicine, Charm		

Adept (3 HD)

Con +0 (12+)	Str +0 (12+)	Dex +0 (12+)
Int +0 (12+)	Wis +0 (12+)	Cha +1 (11+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium	
Armor: 2 / 1	HP: 3d6	
Attacks (12+): mace (1d6 blunt)		
Skills (4+): Lore		
Magic: cause fear, command		

Acolyte (1 HD)

Con +0 (14+)	Str +0 (14+)	Dex +0 (14+)
Int +0 (14+)	Wis +0 (14+)	Cha +1 (13+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium	
Armor: 2 / 1	HP: 6	
Attacks (14+): mace (1d6 blunt)		
Skills (5+): Charm, Wit, Leadership		
Magic: cause fear		

Revenant (3 HD)

Str +2 (10+)	Dex +0 (12+)	Con +2 (10+)
Int +0 (12+)	Wis +0 (12+)	Cha +0 (12+)
Movement: Slow	Size: Medium	
Armor: 3	HP: (3d6+12)	
Attacks (10+): +2 frostbrand (2d6 + 2d6 cold)		
Skills (3+): Charm, Wit, Leadership		
Magic: true strike, cause fear		

Shambler (2 HD)

Con +3 (10+)	Str +2 (11+)	Dex -2 (15+)
Int -3 (16+)	Wis -3 (16+)	Cha —
Movement: Slow	Size: Medium	
Armor: 0	HP: (2d6+6)x2	
Attacks (14+): unarmed (d6+2 blunt), grapple, bite (d6+2)		
Plague: anyone bitten by a shambler must save vs. disease or contract plague.		

Skeleton (1 HD)

Con +2 (14+)	Str +0 (14+)	Dex +0 (14+)
Int -3 (17+)	Wis -3 (17+)	Cha —
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium	
Armor: 2 / 1	HP: 6	
Attacks (14+): shortsword (1d6)		

Lilin (5 HD)

Con +0 (10+)	Str +0 (8+)	Dex +3 (7+)
Int +3 (7+)	Wis +3 (7+)	Cha +10 (7+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium	
Armor: 2	HP: 5d6	
Attacks (--): none, but can cast beguile at-will. The lilin may also touch a willing or beguiled mortal as its action to inflict 2d6 necrotic damage, then regain one expended magic.		
Skills (3+): Finesse, Lore, Bearing, Charm, Wit		
Magic: calm emotions, disguise self, suggestion, grace		

The Abandoned Druid's Grove

The mad hermit druid originally worshipped here with her circle of fellow elven druids, which included Dame MacGeralt and the druid prisoner from the wolf beastfolk's lair. They established this grove long before the coming of the Albions. In response to the Albion threat, the druids used a powerful group ritual to cast a potent mirage glamour over the entire grove, then convened to decide whether to use the shrine to Crom Cruach to fight the Albions, or offer their guidance and council to the newcomers.

The argument quickly grew heated; the vote was strongly in favor of allying, which the hermit could not abide — so they waited till nightfall, slit the throats of their fellow druids, and abandoned the grove for a small hovel south of the river. Dame MacGearalt and her apprentice were the only other survivors of that night, and their vows to the druid circle continue to prevent either from speaking of it or from raising their hands against the hermit.

The grove is still defended by twelve huge treants, who have maintained their vigil since the massacre. It is also haunted by the wraiths of the eleven druids who were slaughtered here. They are severely weakened, both from neglect and from the miasma of evil coming from Crom Cruach's temple; thus they only fight as 2hd huge creatures. The grove is protected by a powerful fey glamour, that makes it impossible to find unless you enter through the blocked cavern in the shrine.

Baensidhe Wraith (3 HD)

Con —	Str —	Dex +0 (12+)
Int +0 (12+)	Wis +0 (12+)	Cha +0 (12+)
Movement: Fly Slow (hover)	Size: Medium	
Armor: (immaterial)	HP: 3d6	
Attacks (12+): drain vitality – 2d6 stunning necrotic damage		
Skills (4+): Stealth, Arcana, Animal Ken, Survival		

Necromancy: The wraith has three glamour, which replenish each sunset. It may spend one glamour to cast cause fear, or two glamour to cast curse ability.

Spirit Form: A wraith is immune to all damage except force, psychic, and radiant damage. When its hit points are reduced to zero it is banished, and cannot manifest again until the next sunrise or sunset.

Treant (2 HD Huge Creature)

Con +4 (9+)	Str +4 (9+)	Dex -3 (16+)
Int -3 (16+)	Wis +2 (11+)	Cha +0 (13+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Huge 3	
Armor: 2 (barkskin)	HP: [1d6+4]	
Attacks (9+): battering blow (1d6 blunt structure)		
Skills (2+): Stealth, Survival		

Sweep: The treant can make a sweep attack as its action if it doesn't move; doing so also costs it its reaction for the round. Any creature within 3 paces of the treant takes 3d6 blunt hit point damage, then immediately saves or is knocked prone.

Barkskin: The treant halves all weapon damage inflicted on it that isn't inflicted by a sundering weapon, but all fire damage against it automatically inflicts the ongoing fire damage condition.

Huge Size: A treant's hit points are split between multiple body sections. When the treant is hit by an attack that wasn't easy, the attacker must roll 2d6 and consult the following chart:

3-4	Left Leg	1x [hp]
5	Left Arm	1x [hp]
6-8	Body	4x [hp]
9	Right Arm	1x [hp]
10-11	Right Leg	1x [hp]
12, 12*	Head	½ [hp]

***Cripple:** A critical hit to any location reduces that location to 0 hp; reducing the body to 0 hp kills the treant, while reducing a leg to 0 hp hobbles it, reducing an arm to 0 hp makes all attacks harder, and reducing the face to 0 hp blinds it.

Frenzy: Whenever any section is reduced to 0 damage, the treant immediately replenishes all glamour and regains its reaction, and may immediately use its reaction to make a sweep attack.

Primal Magic: The treant has 2 glamour. It can cast any Wood-aspected spell by spending glamour equal to its circle.

Regenerate: As its action, the treant can spend 1 glamour, then choose a damaged section and roll 1d6+4, healing that many hit points in that section.

Crossing the Barrow

The Palace of Silver and Crimson is to the south of the Pale Keep, across the Barrow. It was once considered subject to the crown, but fell faerie magics have since reclaimed the territory.

Once the troubles with the Caves are sorted out, the Palace is a logical next step for the adventuring party to explore.

The Faerie Wilds

The Palace of Silver and Crimson was a keep and abbey called Ceatherlach, originally built by the Crown of Albion in 3445 to fortify the bordermarch of the Pale against the Eire barbarians and their fey allies. It fell into ruin a century ago, when the Plague decimated the garrison and the mists of Faerie reclaimed the land. The magics of Faerie have since warped the palace into a dreamlike mockery of its original form.

Silver and Crimson

A century ago, as the keep and its surrounding village succumbed to plague, the druidess Dame Alice Kyteler and her coven turned to a legendary Faerie artifact called "Croidhe mo Mhaistir" to attempt to protect the land from the disease and the hordes of shambling undead that it spawned. Legends say that "Croidhe mo Mhaistir" is a legendary dragon pearl in the form of a deep crimson ruby, cut and polished into a fist-sized faceted globe.

Whatever the intent of their magic, the actual effect was the encroachment of the Fey mists deep into the bordermarch. Most of the keep's mortal inhabitants fled during the initial fey incursion, and no one who has ventured into the area since has returned to report what they have seen; those first refugees claimed that thick vines with razor-sharp thorns began growing over every possible surface, choking out all avenues of escape.

The Path to the Palace

The Faerie wilds leading up to the palace are unusually dangerous, even for Faerie. The first obstacle to surmount is the Misty Moor, a vast enchanted wetland with a strange curse.

The Misty Moor

Any magic attempted within the moor's mists will become twisted by the chaotic energies of Faerie, producing any number of unintended effects. Anyone attempting magic must make a saving throw vs. curses; if they fail, they roll a d6 and consult the following chart:

D6 Wild Magic Effect

- 1 The target of the magic is determined randomly. If a magic effect can only target the caster or a creature touched by the caster, the magic instead reverses its normal effect.
- 2 A random primal glamour of the same circle as the magic being attempted is cast instead.
- 3 The magic fails to cast at all. The referee should note the circle of the magic, and add it to a running total of all magics absorbed by the swamp in this manner.
- 4 The magic's effective circle is amplified by the total amount of magic absorbed by the swamp from result '3' up until this point, up to the effect of a third-circle magic. Any remaining absorbed magic is released in the form of random primal glammers, cast at random targets.
- 5 The caster and target must both save vs. curses; this roll is hard if the swamp has absorbed any magic. On a failure, that creature is caught in between the Material and Faerie until the next sunrise or sunset. They appear insubstantial and unable to affect either plane of existence, but are still affected by either (and can be damaged from attacks originating from either).
- 6 The caster is involuntarily transformed into a 1d6 hit die creature, as per the effects of the polymorph potion.

The Moorfoul Mountains

The Moorfoul Mountains were once called the Deerpeak Mines, until the faerie mists made mining too dangerous. Various caves and abandoned mines dot the barren crags, many of which now serve as dens for dangerous fey beasts, fey monsters, or goblin orcs.

The palace itself lies just south of the range, in a wide river valley formed by the Barrow and Nore rivers. The palace's towers are visible from the westernmost peaks of the Moorfouls.

Approaching the Palace

The palace is a stunning sight, carved from white marble towers with beautiful silver filigree inlaid into the architecture. Winding around the towers and covering the walls is a tangled mass of thick rosebushes, with blooms in every shade from white to pink to a deep crimson. Various parts of the castle walls have been penetrated and even broken open by the thorns, even collapsing a few of the towers.

The rosevines spread out across the ground for a full half-league around the keep itself, with vicious-looking thorns jutting out in every direction in between the beautiful flowers. When viewed at night, the roses and thorns can be seen to emit a faint red glow, and a brighter glow can be seen to emanate from the windows of the tallest tower.

South of the Mountains

The party can choose to explore the areas south of the Moorfoul mountains first, instead of heading directly into the palace. These were once prosperous lands, and still struggle to eke out a living amongst the daily chaos of the feymists.

Moinin-Rua

The village of Moinin-Rua was once a prosperous agricultural settlement, where gnome farmers supplied the dwarven miners in the Deerpeak mountains with food in exchange for gems and precious metals. The town is still barely prosperous enough to support two taverns, one with an inn; it also has a small general store and smithy. The blacksmith is a first-level dweomersmith, a descendant of the dwarves who used to mine the Deerpeaks.

Castlecomer

West of Moinin-Rua, and just south of the palace, is the dwarven mining settlement of Castlecomer. The dwarves are long gone, so Lady d'Meath's henchmen run the town, while the gnomish townsfolk try to distract themselves with the breeding and training of thoroughbred horses.

Cill-Chainnigh

The current seat of power in the region is the castle at Cill-Chainnigh, where the self-styled Lady d'Meath rules with an iron fist. D'Meath is a sixth-level elven druidess who has made various pacts with the local fair folk to secure her rule over the past century. She is attended to by a pack of boar pucca, all kept loyal with the judicious use of beguiling glamours. These henchmen are all second level champions or hunters; their leaders are third-level. The "common folk" of the surrounding town are all various forms of faun beastfolk; it is a well-kept secret that most of them are descended from the original human inhabitants of the town, who were transformed into beastfolk by the encroaching fey mists.

The tinker's shop in Cill-Chainnigh stands out for its unusually cheery atmosphere, given the dreary oppression of the rest of the shire. The tinker and his daughter are dwarves who are usually found traveling the countryside in an elaborate covered stagecoach (actually a Folding Carriage), although they can be found in their shop at least two days out of each week. Any non-stealthy mortal NPC encounter on the road has a 1 in 6 chance of being Gabhann or Fiona. Gabhann is a fifth-level dweomersmith, while Fiona (who takes after her gnomish mother) is a third-level druid. Both of them have exceptional Charisma, and Fiona is an incorrigible flirt.

The Feywoods

To the west of Cill-Chainnigh are a patch of dark forest called the Feywoods. This forest is densely populated by all kinds of fey beasts and monsters; the referee should roll for a random encounter for each 100 paces of travel through the woods, using the encounter tables on page 38 of the Referee's Guide.

The Stormpeaks

South of Cill-Chainnigh are the Stormpeaks, a range of mountains perpetually wreathed by stormclouds and lightning. Dame Kyteler and Lady d'Meath once attempted to use the Croidhe mo Mhaistir to alter the weather of this region; the result is an ungovernable chaos of auriad nymphs and hags fighting amongst each other, while the thyrsa trolls who originally inhabited the region hide away in their caves.

Arriving at the Palace

The path to the palace gates is an ornate stone bridge over the Nore river. White rosebush vines with unusually long and sharp thorns wind their way around the statues and lanterns on the bridge, and completely cover the marble walls of the palace keep.

The entire eastern half of the palace has been pulled down; a hard skill check (or normal difficulty if rolled by a dwarf) will notice that the weight and crushing power of the vines has essentially undermined the foundations of the eastern palace, then pulled down the ramparts and crushed them to rubble. The process seems to be slowly encroaching onto the western half of the palace, but it looks sturdy enough that there is no immediate danger of collapse.

Crossing the bridge will require a saving throw from each member of the party, to avoid triggering the bloodrose vines. Once everyone has reached the other side, the portcullis gates are jammed shut, and will require multiple party members to lift. Each member of the party that aids in the attempt contributes 1d6 + their Strength, and each attempt takes one combat round; the portcullis opens once the party rolls a combined total of 10 or more.

Of course, the bloodroses will be attempting to grapple the party the whole time, so they will need to split their efforts between lifting the gate and hacking or burning the vines back. The bloodroses aren't really mobile or capable of strategy, so this doesn't require initiative rolls the way normal combat encounters do; simply let the party decide each round who is on gate duty and who is fighting the bushes.

Once the party is inside the first portcullis, it will crash back down. There are two doors on either side of the archway; each leads to a small gatehouse with a lever. Putting both levers to the 'up' or 'down' position will raise or lower the inner and outer gates.

The western room has a small, hard-to-find secret door that is hidden behind two barrels; behind it is a room with two wooden chests and a weapon rack; within are two suits of chainmail, two crossbows, and two shields.

Bloodrose

(L5 Infernal Plant)

The rosebushes entwining the palace are fey abominations that drink blood. Whenever a creature attempts to move through a space adjacent to them, that creature must save vs. blast or cone to avoid being scratched; the referee should make these saving throws in secret the first time a creature passes by a rosebush. Attempting to touch a rosebush, even on an apparently non-thorny part of a vine, is treated as failing this saving throw.

A creature that fails this saving throw immediately suffers 1d6+1 piercing damage and ongoing bleeding damage, as the vines twist and lash to drive the thorns deeper into their flesh. If this damage die rolls a '6', that creature is grabbed and restrained by the thornbushes unless they succeed at a save vs. knockdown, suffering another d6 piercing damage as they are grabbed. A restrained creature suffers another d6 piercing damage each round, and must use their action to make a hard save vs. knockdown until they manage to free themselves.

As the bloodroses inflict damage, the flowers around them change color from white, to pink, to deep red. Whenever a creature critically fails their saving throw vs. a bush, that creature suffers a critical hit and all the petals fall off of the blooms on that 5' patch of bush. The next round, each of the exposed rose hips explode, sending razor-sharp shrapnel in a blast 4 paces in radius that deals 3d6+1 piercing damage and ongoing bleeding damage. The next round after that, every inch of exposed surface within the blast area starts growing new rosevines, which continue to grow and mature over 1d6 rounds until they produce their own thorns and flowers.

Each 5' patch of bloodrose is treated as a separate large "creature" with 1d6 structure points, although they have no abilities and cannot move or perform actions. Attack throws against a bloodrose are easy, since it fills a 5' space and can't move or dodge.

Attacks from an ax weapon or fire inflict direct structure damage, while other attacks follow the normal rules for attacking a structure. If a bloodrose is lit on fire, it has a 1-in-6 chance of spreading the flames to each adjacent bush.

The West Wing

Heading down the western corridor leads to a long hallway with series of doors on the left. Everything in these hallways and rooms looks incredibly expensive and well-decorated, with thick velvet tapestries, black-and-white tile floors, and brass braziers mounted into the oak-and-limestone walls.

The Schoolroom

This room appears to have been a laboratory for training apprentice wizards; there are several desks with inkwells and quill pens, and papers are strewn about the floor. Any wizard character can spend an exploration round making a hard Science check to attempt to make any sense of the notes and formulae strewn about; on a success, they manage to piece together one random first-circle spell that they can then copy into their spellbook.

The Pantry

The pantry contains numerous sacks of grain and barrels of ale, as well as various salted meats and dried fruits - there is enough fare provisioned here to produce 2d6 x 30 daily rations of food, if necessary.

The Kitchen

The next room is a well-stocked kitchen. The stove is still warm, and cooking implements and ingredients are strewn about as if dinner had just been prepared. Some of the pots have been ransacked and smashed against the floor, with smeared footprints leading out of the room. An easy Survival check will determine that these were made by redcaps, and somewhat recently at that.

The Dining Hall

The dining hall is laid out for an exquisite banquet, and smells delicious. Sitting around the table are a dozen redcap goblins, enjoying a gourmet feast. A larger, fatter redcap in an apron and a chef's cap is standing in the corner of the room with his arms crossed, smiling smugly; he's holding a cleaver (treat as an ax). The other goblins are wearing shortswords in their belts, and have set their crossbows beside their chairs as they eat.

As wonderful as the meal smells, it is goblin cooking; the meat was recently a young bear pucca named Maddy.

The Barracks

The hallway loops around, then branches into a natural cavern to the west and a second, smaller hallway to the north. The left-hand wall of this hallway has two doors, each of which open into a barracks room.

The southern barracks room is locked; the lock is of normal complexity, but the goblins still haven't managed to pick it. Opening it reveals six pristine bunk beds with a locker at the foot of each bed, as well as two weapon racks against the southern wall. Opening the lockers and searching the weapon racks will reveal six suits of chainmail, six shortswords, six medium shields, four crossbows, and two glaives. All are of exceptional quality, but do not count as masterwork weapons or armor.

The northern barracks room is open, and is being used as quarters by the redcaps that are currently occupying the dining hall. They have thoroughly wrecked the beds, lockers, glaives, and chainmail that they found, but are using the crossbows and shortswords.

Redcap Hunter (L1) x 12

Con +1 (13+)	Str +0 (14+)	Dex +1 (13+)
Int -1 (15+)	Wis +0 (14+)	Cha +0 (14+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Small	
Armor: 1 / 0 (leather)	HP: 4	
Attacks (13+):crossbow (d6+1 piercing / range 15)		
Feats: Backstab, Evasion		
Skills (4+): Stealth		

Redcap Druid "Chef" (L1)

Con +1 (13+)	Str +0 (14+)	Dex +1 (13+)
Int -1 (15+)	Wis +0 (14+)	Cha +0 (14+)
Movement:	5 paces	Size: Small
Armor:	2 / 0 (hide)	HP: 4
Attacks (13+): axe (2d6 sundering)		
Skills (4+): Stealth		
Magic: water ①		

The Caves

The cavern walls are smooth and dry stone, with thin veins of precious metals streaked throughout. Rather than mine them, the keep's architects chose to make this entire cavern into a causeway that leads to a bath house powered by geothermal vents.

The Northern Cavern

There is a straw bed laid out and a chain bolted into the wall here; a young bear cub is chained here, which someone appears to have been trying to train. It is emaciated and starving, which has put it in a state of perpetual frenzy. Its wrought-iron collar has worn a raw, red bald patch around its neck.

If the party can subdue the bear without killing it, and manages to remove the collar, the bear will turn out to be a young pucca girl named Mairead. She will tell the party that her twin brother Maddy and older sister Aine were taken by the redcaps months ago, and that Aine was given to the bugbears that live in the upper levels. The redcaps had been trying to fatten her and her brother up before eating them, but finally gave up and decided to cook them as they are when they refused to eat anything offered to them.

Mairead is severely malnourished, and in poor health. If taken care of and allowed to heal, her Constitution will slowly return to its original value of +0 over the course of a few months. She is seven years old, clever, and incredibly strong-willed and stubborn.

Mairead (L1 Bear Pucca)			
Con -2 (16+)	Str +0 (14+)	Dex +0 (14+)	
Int +1 (13+)	Wis +2 (12+)	Cha +1 (13+)	
Movement:	5 paces	Size:	Small
Armor:	none	HP:	2 (max 4)
Attacks (14+):	none		
Skills (4+):	Alertness, Survival, Bearing		
Feats:	can transform into a bear at-will		

Bear Cub Form

Con +1 (12+)	Str +3 (10+)	Dex +1 (12+)	
Int +1 (12+)	Wis +2 (11+)	Cha -1 (14+)	
Movement:	5 paces	Size:	Medium
Armor:	2	HP:	2d6+2
Attacks (10+):	claws (2d6), grapple (2d6+3 blunt)		
Skills (4+):	Alertness, Survival		

The Southern Cavern

The southern half of the cave has a shrine, originally devoted to the local Numen-saint that watched over these lands. A stone statue of mother-and-infant stands here; sickly pale vines with sharp blood-red thorns wind tight around all of the stonework, with ghostly white roses blooming in between the thorns. The vines give the impression of strangling the statues of the mother and child. There are twelve smaller votive statues that originally encircled the shrine, but the vines have pulled them down and crushed them.

Bloodstirge (L1 Fey Monster) x 1d6+2

Bloodstirges are giant, bloated mosquitoes with powerful gripping claws on their forelegs. While not particularly dangerous alone, a large swarm of bloodstirges can drain a mortal of blood in seconds.

Con -2 (16+)	Str -3 (17+)	Dex +3 (11+)
Int -4 (17+)	Wis +0 (14+)	Cha -4 (17+)
Movement:	Fly	Size: Tiny
Armor:	0	HP: 1
Attacks (17+):	latch on (grapple), bite (1 hp)	
Skills (5+):	Agility, Stealth, Alertness	
Senses:	Can sense warm-blooded creatures from up to 10 paces away	

Drain Blood - A stirge that latches onto a victim will stay attached for 1d6 combat rounds. Each round, the victim must make a saving throw vs. disease or lose 1 point of Constitution (reducing both hit points and maximum hit points accordingly).

Lost Constitution heals at 1 point per day, or can be healed immediately with a restoration miricle; until it is healed, the afflicted creature cannot heal hit point damage through rest.

Disease Carrier - A creature bitten by a stirge that achieves a critical hit, or a creature with a stirge latched onto it when that stirge is killed, must make a saving throw vs. disease or contract the plague.

The Bathhouse

Each of these four rooms is shaped like an oblong hexagon; together, they fill the octagonal tower and surround a smaller square room.

Changing Room

This room contains two large oak cabinets full of drawers, both ornately carved with scenes of springtime and inlaid with mother-of-pearl. The wall opposite them has a large mirror and two marble washbasins. The floor is white and black marble, flecked with gold and mica. There are a few small wooden chairs and benches of fine quality along the smaller side walls, some with towels folded neatly and laid on top of them.

If the players search the cabinets, they will find various bath towels and bathrobes made from expensive cloth, as well as many bars of perfumed soap carved into the shapes of mermaids and leaping dolphins. One small drawer in the center of the farther cabinet is locked with a complex pressure-lock, which can only be picked by someone with expertise; even then, attempting to pick it is hard, and failure activates a poisoned needle trap. (The drawer can be properly opened with the silver locket in the central room of the tower, but that solution has its own set of problems.) Inside this drawer is a small gold-and-iron key, worth 150 gp if sold.

Sunken Bath

This room is quite warm and humid. The majority of the room is taken up by a sunken bath of white marble, filled with warm water. There are lavish alabaster frescoes on the walls of swans, naiads, and mermaids. In the far corner of the room is a marble table with seven flasks made of various semiprecious stones, and a large peacock feather fan. There is a buzzing sound coming from above.

A large bloodstirge nest has formed in the upper corner above the table; at any given time there are 1d6+2 bloodstirges roosting. They will immediately stir if anyone enters the room, and move to attack and feed.

Five of the flasks on the table contain bath oils. The last two contain actual alchemical concoctions - one is a love potion, and the other is a potion of shared sensations.

Mosaic Room

This room is covered in mosaic frescoes made from small hexagonal tiles of obsidian, lapis lazuli, agate, and other colorful stones, inlaid with gold and silver. They show a knight in silver plate armor riding a silver dragon, and a woman in white wearing a golden crown with a red heart emblazoned on the chest of her gown. The scenes progress through a courtship tryptich, with the floor depicting the dragon, knight, and woman all lying asleep around a central gold-and-obsidian star motif, with a brass keyhole in the center of the star.

Picking the keyhole requires expertise, and is hard even then; failure activates a magic trap which banishes a would-be thief directly into the Elemental Chaos (see pg. 21). The gold key hidden in the changing room unlocks the safe; inside is a rare mithril longsword with a ruby pommel, enchanted as an aetheric blade.

Steam Room

This room is hot and humid, and filled with a thick mist that obscures vision.

It is actually a sauna, with wooden benches along the walls and vents in the floor that release steam from a geothermal spring deep below the keep.

Pink Pedestal

This small square room sits in the center of the four hexagonal rooms. In the middle of this room is a carved stone pedestal, apparently made of rose quartz. Upon the pedestal is a small pink satin pillow, and resting on the pillow is an ornate oval locket made of silver, on a silver chain. The locket is closed.

This locket is an Amulet of Friendship, worn by Dame Kyteler's betrothed; its match is still a golden locket that is still around the Dame's neck. If anyone puts on the locket, she will immediately be aware of it, and can instantly begin casting glammers on the wearer. The locket is cursed so that it cannot be removed.

The first glamour that Dame Kyteler will cast on the wearer is Beguile, attempting to bend the wearer to her will. Once she has eroded the victim's mental defenses, she will compel them to make a Primal Oath to her, to serve her unquestioningly and hide their betrayal from their companions. The party will now have a traitor in their midst.

The East Wing

From the portcullis, the east wing corridor loops around a 30' wide square pillar, before branching off to the south and east. There is a single door in the middle of the easternmost corridor of the loop.

Hothouse Garden

This room was originally a garden atrium for growing delicate exotic plants; the roof of the room is made of stained glass and naturally lets in enough light for plants to survive. It has been completely taken over by bloodrose bushes; as soon as the door is opened, vines burst outwards in a 5-pace cone and deal 1d6 piercing damage to anyone who fails to save.

Cavern Pool

To the north of the hothouse garden door is a staircase carved out of raw rock; it leads down into a small cavern with a still pool of fresh water, which the architects deemed too pretty to destroy. Sunlight filters in softly from holes in the cavern roof, and glitters off of small rainbow-hued crystals that grow on the cavern walls. A stream flows in from above, feeding the pool; there are clay-covered iron pipes submerged in the water at the southern edge of the pool, which appear to run underground beneath the palace.

Sulfurous Pool

The cavern directly south of the hothouse garden contains a pool of hot, sulfurous water. An ingenious dwarven apparatus sits here, apparently of Old Imperial design; it heats and pumps the water for the entire palace through a series of thick, clay-covered iron pipes. The air in this room is poisonous; anyone who stays in the room more than a few minutes must save vs. poison at the end of each exploration round, or suffer 1d6 damage and be rendered unconscious.

Storeroom

South of the pools is a storeroom, full of crates of salted and jerked meat, dried fruits and nuts, and other preserved foods. Several boxes are full of prepared and packaged ration satchels, for guards to take on long patrols. Altogether, there are 2d6 x 10 days' worth of rations prepared, and enough supplies to make another 2d6 x 100 days' worth.

Blocked Passage

Past the storeroom, the hallway turns eastward, ending at a large arched doorway. Past that doorway is another small corridor that used to serve as an exit into the palace gardens; it has become completely overgrown with bloodroses, which will immediately burst outwards in a 5-pace cone and deal 1d6 piercing damage to anyone who fails to save.

Fountain Room

This room contains an ornamental fountain in the corner, as well as two tapestries - one of a woman in white with a golden crown and a red heart on her chest, the other of a silver knight riding a silver dragon.

Secret Room

If the party searches behind the tapestry of the white princess, they will notice a loose stone; pressing it causes a hidden passageway to open, which leads eastward into a secret room furnished as a study. On an expensive red velvet chair is a leather-bound book; the first page of the book identifies it as the private diary of Dame Alice Kyteler.

Anteroom

The western door of the fountain room leads to an anteroom, which can also be reached from the southernmost corridor of the West Wing. This room is a semicircular alcove, with a two beautiful caryatid statues of young women acting as pillars. These are actually living oreiad nymphs, bound by fey oaths to protect the palace from intruders.

Oreiad

(L5 Fair Folk) x2

Oreiades are nymphs that bind themselves to the earth itself, usually to a particular large boulder, vein of crystal, or precious metal.

Con +3 (7+)	Str +1 (9+)	Dex +0 (10+)
Int +0 (10+)	Wis +3 (7+)	Cha +3 (7+)
Movement: Immobile	Size: Medium	
Armor: 3	HP: 7d6+9 + 2 SP	
Attacks (7+): obsidian shards (1d6 piercing)		
Skills (3+): Intuition, Survival, Charm		
Magic - The oreiad has 7 glamour, and may cast any Stone-, Beast-, or Fey-aspected glamour by spending glamour equal to its circle.		
Recharge - As its action, the oreiad may regain one primal attunement, or may roll a hit die and heal that many hit points. On a '6', it heals one structure.		

The Southeast Wing

South of the antechamber is a set of hallways leading to the southern wings of the palace.

Schoolroom and Library

The first two rooms in the southern wing are a schoolroom and library, connected by a short hallway. The schoolroom contains nothing of interest, but the library contains 1d6-1 wizard spells and one magic item blueprint; you can use Appendix E of the Referee's Guide to roll for which spells and blueprint are found.

Fitting Room

As you open the door to this room, the party immediately sees 1d6 vaguely humanoid shadows lunging menacingly towards them.

The shadows are being cast from a flickering lamp that is behind a folding privacy screen; behind it are six harmless mannequins.

Larder

This large room is a butcher's room and larder. There is a trap door in the floor, which falls 30 feet into a shallow river; this is used to dispose of offal and other rubbish from the castle. The larder itself is a natural cave kept magically cold through elemental faerie magic - meat is butchered, then packed in ice and stored here until it is ready to be cooked.

Lounge

South of the larder is an elegant lounge, with plush velvet couches and expensive-looking tapestries. In the center of the room is a harp, which appears to have been carved from a single piece of quartz crystal and strung with thin mithril wire.

The harp is a legendary primal artifact, and is bound to a human bard of remarkable skill who was taken to Faerie when the castle fell. She has been entertaining the Fair Folk courts for the past century, having never aged a day. If the harp is plucked, a portal into deeper Faerie will open, and the bard Rowena will step out, accompanied by two elf bodyguards.

Rowena will happily discuss the events that led to the palace's current state, but she will only be allowed to stay in the material world for a single hour; if the party shows her any hostility or offence, her two elven bodyguards will immediately push her back through the portal, then attack the party.

Rowena

(L9 Bard)

Con +0 (6+)	Str +0 (6+)	Dex +1 (5+)
Int +1 (5+)	Wis +1 (5+)	Cha +3 (5+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium	
Armor: 3 / 2 (mithril chainmail)	HP: 9d6	
Attacks (6+): rapier (1d6 piercing)		
Skills (2+): All skills; she's had a century to study		
Magic: Rowena is a level 9 Priest of the Beauty domain.		

Elf Bodyguards (L7 Mystic Champion) x2

Con +1 (7+)	Str +1 (7+)	Dex +2 (6+)
Int +1 (7+)	Wis +1 (7+)	Cha +1 (7+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium	
Armor: 4 / 3 (mithril plate)	HP: 9d6+27	
Attacks (4+):+3 mithril keen longsword (1d6+1)		
Skills (3+): Agility, Finesse, Alertness, Intuition, Bearing		
Feats: Battle-trance x4		

Lizardfolk Lair

At the far southeast corner of the castle, a small room appears to have been expanded by removing the south wall and carving crudely into the bare rock. In one corner of the room is an finely-wrought silver statue of a dragon, with what appears to be crude offerings of worship piled around it; against the opposite corner is a heaped nest of straw and filthy but high-quality cloth, which serves as a nest for 2d6 kobolds and their "bonemother" druid.

Kobold Hunters

(L1) x2d6

Str +1 (13+)	Dex +1 (13+)	Con +0 (14+)
Int -1 (15+)	Wis +0 (14+)	Cha +0 (14+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Small	
Armor: 2 (natural scales)	HP: 3	
Attacks (13+): Shortbow (1d6 piercing / range 10)		
Feats: Backstab, Evasion		
Skills (5+): Agility, Finesse, Stealth, Perception		

Kobold Druid

(L3)

Con +0 (12+)	Str +0 (12+)	Dex +1 (11+)
Int +0 (12+)	Wis +1 (11+)	Cha +0 (12+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Small	
Armor: 2 (natural scales)	HP: 3d6+2	
Attacks (12+): quarterstaff (2d6 blunt)		
Skills (4+): Arcana, Animal Ken, Survival, Wit		
Magic: fey or beast ①, stone ①		

The Southwest Wing

The hallways turn south behind the dining hall, leading down a long corridor with a few doors before turning west.

Captain's Quarters

The first room of the southwest wing was the quarters for the captain of the guard, and is the scene of a grisly murder. The bedsheets are soaked with blood, the tables and chairs have been upturned and smashed, and the captain's footlocker has been broken open.

Scattered across the floor are various bloody papers; they contain ledgers and timetables, detailing the logistics of the captain's job.

Barracks

These barracks contain five double bunk beds and footlockers, as well as a weapon rack against the opposite wall. All are empty.

Escape Room

Opposite the barracks door is a secret door that requires a hard Alertness check to notice. The brazier opposite this secret door has a small lever hidden among the ornamentation; pulling that lever will open the door. As the door is solid stone and flush with the wall, there is no easy way to brute-force it open.

This room contains a chair, a brazier, a flask of lamp oil, and a lever which locks the secret door when pulled down, or opens it when pulled up. On the ceiling of the room is a trapdoor hidden by the stonework, which leads to the palace's upper level. Climbing through the trapdoor is an easy Agility feat, which is automatic for anyone with expertise.

Armory

The armory to the south contains a dozen masterwork glaives, a dozen masterwork longswords, a dozen masterwork medium shields, and two dozen masterwork suits of chainmail. This chainmail will only provide its masterwork bonus if it is re-fitted to its new wearer, which requires a hard Finesse check and a day's effort for a human or fey armorer, or an easy Finesse check and an exploration round for a dweomersmith.

Guardpost

This room was originally a guardpost. There is a slit along the eastern wall of the room, where guards could fire at invaders from the hallway. The last surviving palace guard, Travis, holed up here when the bloodroses choked out every available escape route. He has been kept alive and ageless by the magic of Faerie, but in the intervening decades he has gone quite mad.

Travis has made a straw bed in one corner of the room, and there is a table with a plate from the dining hall, a pewter goblet, and a pair of knives. If the party approaches the room from the north, Travis will use his +2 flying dagger to attack them once they are within 10 paces of the hallway's corner.

Travis				(L3 Warrior)	
Con	+1	(11+)	Str	+1	(11+)
Int	+0	(12+)	Wis	+0	(12+)
Dex	+0	(12+)	Cha	-1	(13+)
Movement:	5 paces			Size:	Medium
Armor:	3 / 2 (+1 chainmail)			HP:	3d6+9
Attacks (14+):	+2 flying dagger (1d6+2 piercing)				
Skills (5+):	None of note				
Feats:	Cleave, Evasion				

Hidden within the straw of Travis's mattress are various treasures that he has scavenged from the lower levels. A small chest contains a pair of rubies and a large emerald; each ruby is worth 300 drakh and the emerald is worth 2000 drakh. There is also a gold wedding ring worth 10 gp, and a ring with a set of iron keys.

Bailiff's Room

South of the guardpost is the bailiff's room, where prisoners were checked in and processed. It contains a thick oak table, a finely crafted wooden chair, a brass candelabra, inkwell, and several reams of parchment.

Bailiff's Quarters

Further along this corridor is a door to the bailiff and gaolers' quarters. It contains four beds, a small table, and a long set of drawers full of clothes. There is a weapon rack along the back wall with four shortswords, four iron maces, four helmets, and four heavy shields.

Gaol

The jail itself is mostly a natural cavern, with a series of 10' x 10' cells built into the back with stonework, mortar, and iron bars.

The Cavern

North of the gaol, the cavern opens up into a network of twisty passages. Further along into these passages are a set of clay pots, each containing a withered tropical plant. These plants were 'rescued' from the hothouse when the bloodroses began to bloom, but have since died from lack of sunlight. Against the back wall of this passage is a wall completely covered in bloodrose vines, which seems somehow unaffected by the lack of sunlight.

Cavern Pool

At the far end of the cavern network is a small pool, filled with what looks like a vivid purple ink. Any cloth, leather, or skin dipped into this ink will be dyed a deep royal purple by the minerals that have leached into the water here. The minerals in the pool also have enough ambient materia to serve as magic ink for aetheric arcane spells; noticing this is a hard Science check, or a trivial application of the identify magic spell. At the far end of the pool is a large silver statue of a knight.

Upon approaching the pool, 1d6+1 insect-like creatures will crawl out of a recessed crevice behind the party. Each of these creatures is the size of a small dog, and resembles a cricket with a long feathered tail and feathered antennae. They will immediately swarm anyone wearing steel armor or wielding a heavy steel weapon or steel shield, and begin covering it with corrosive spittle; then they will devour the rusted and pitted metal that results.

The left pinky finger of the knight statue has a ring of protection on its last knuckle, which can be slipped off easily. Detect magic or identify magic effects will fail unless they are directly adjacent to the statue, because of the ambient energies emanating from the ink pool itself. The ring is the same color of silver as the statue, so noticing it at all requires an up-close inspection.

Rustgrub

(2nd Fey Monster)

Rustgrubs are the larvae of rust hulks, which are capable of chewing through and digesting metal. They are attracted to iron and steel but ignore flesh.

Harvesting - If properly harvested, a rustgrub yields 1d6 materia charges, half of which are water materia and half of which are stone materia.

Con +2 (11+)	Str -3 (17+)	Dex -2 (15+)
Int -4 (17+)	Wis -2 (15+)	Cha -4 (17+)
Movement: Slow	Size: Medium	
Armor: 1	HP: (2d6+4)	
Attacks (17+): bite (0 hp, sundering)		
Skills (4+): Stealth		
Senses: Can sense ferrous metals from up to 5 paces away		

Rust Metal - A rustgrub's saliva will reduce the effectiveness of any steel weapon, shield, or armor by 1 point per round until it is either washed off, or the gear is completely destroyed. Any non-metallic gear with steel or iron fasteners instead makes a 12+ saving throw each round that it is exposed.

Spit - A rustgrub has two glamour, which it can spend to propel a gob of corrosive saliva at anyone within 3 paces that it senses is wearing steel armor or wielding a steel weapon (treat as a range 1 thrown attack). This deals zero hit point damage, but begins sundering steel weapons at 1 point per round until it is washed off, or the gear is completely destroyed.

Watchrooms

At the other far end of the caverns are a pair of large square room, where guards could gather and mount defenses. The first room has been converted into a secondary nest for the kobold pack in the southeast wing; if any kobolds escape, they will regroup here. If the kobolds haven't been encountered yet, a random encounter check should be made at the end of each exploration round that the party spends in this room to see if a patrol of 1d6 kobolds stumbles onto the party.

The further of the two rooms is empty except for an iron ladder in the middle of the room, which leads up to the upper levels of the palace. Bloodrose vines wrap their way around the ladder.

The Upper Levels

The upper levels of the keep are the palace proper, where the lord of the keep entertains visitors and attends to matters of state. It has suffered extensive damage from the bloodrose infestation; only the western half of the palace is still standing. Entry is only possible through an iron ladder leading up a watchtower along the western wall.

Watchtower

The upper level of the watchtower is empty except for the trapdoor leading back down to the lower level, and the bloodrose vines that cover every square inch of the walls.

An L-shaped hallway leads northeast from the watchtower; at the far end of that hallway is a hard-to-detect stone trapdoor in the floor. This leads to the escape room on the lower levels.

Laboratory

The keep's chief alchemist kept a research laboratory here. The books along the walls can be searched to discover up to five arcane spell scrolls; searching takes one exploration round and has a 3-in-6 chance of discovering a scroll if no scrolls have been found yet, a 2-in-6 chance if one or two scrolls have already been found, or a 1-in-6 chance if three or more scrolls have been found. You can determine which spell scrolls are discovered randomly.

The alchemist's formula book is displayed much more prominently; it contains the alchemical procedures for brewing elixirs of healing, regeneration, antivenin, enhanced Constitution, and enhanced Charisma, as well as love potions, truth serum, sovereign glue, salve of slipperiness, and an experimental uncommon potion which allows two imbibers to share each other's emotions and sensations for 1d6 hours, followed by 1d6 days of each imbibers finding the other utterly repulsive to be around. Next to the formula book are 1d6 charges of each kind of materia, plus 1d6 bottles of each kind of magic ink (roll for each element). There are also high-quality tools and equipment, which make the brewing of any alchemistries easier when used in a laboratory.

Across a small hallway from the laboratory itself is the alchemist's private chambers, including a storeroom and a washroom. Sitting on the alchemist's desk is a wand of fireball with three charges.

Chaplain's Bedroom

Next along the hallway is the chaplain's bedroom, where the high priest of the palace's chapel slept and meditated. There is a large canopy bed with heavy red velvet curtains, a long stained oak dresser and matching desk-of-drawers and chair.

When the party enters the room, they will immediately be attacked by flying furniture and other odds-and-ends. The chaplain of the palace still haunts the room, cursed to lash out in impotent rage at anyone who passes by. The chaplain cannot manifest enough of a body to be harmed by any kind of attack; he can only make ranged attacks with a 13+ attack throw threshold. Thrown odds-and-ends each deal 1d6 blunt damage, while heavy furniture (like the desk or chair) has a harder attack throw but 2d6 blunt damage.

The speak with dead miracle can be used to calm the chaplain down, in which case he can be interrogated to hear his story about the palace and its curse.

The Chapel and Sanctuary

There is a small alcove between the chapel and the chaplain's chambers, which contains two chairs and a prayer book. Beyond it is the chapel itself, which has been thoroughly desecrated. The devotional altar has been smeared with blood, and a small shrine to Crom Cruach has been set up around the altar. A bonfire between the altar and the pews appears to be used to make burnt offerings of the remains of those sacrificed.

If the party has been stealthy up until this point, there are three bugbear champions sleeping on the pews. If not, the bugbears should roll Alertness to see if they hear the party coming; prepared bugbears will be laying in wait in the sanctuary, ready to ambush the party when they enter.

Bugbear Champion (4 HD)

Con +3 (8+)	Str +3 (8+)	Dex +1 (10+)
Int -2 (13+)	Wis +0 (11+)	Cha +0 (11+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Large	
Armor: 2 / 0 (hide)	HP: (4d6+20)x2	
Attacks (8+): oversized greatsword (3d6+3)		
Feats: Panther Frenzy x2, Evasion		
Skills (4+): Stealth, Alertness, Survival		

The Grand Ballroom

This vast ballroom is decorated in silver and crimson tapestries, with seven sturdy oak dining tables, an open floor, and a silver-inlaid grand piano. The room is eerily quiet, and the party's footsteps echo from the walls as they cross it.

The Palace Gardens

The palace gardens are, of course, completely overgrown with bloodrose vines. Each pace of movement along the path requires a saving throw to avoid being slashed by the thorns; the party might reasonably decide that it would be simpler to just slash or burn their way through. Unfortunately, these bloodroses are being fed directly by unholy energies, and will regrow within one combat round of being burned or slashed. This same energy makes the plants vulnerable to the rebuke the unholy miracle, which inflicts 1d6 structure damage to each plant within 10 paces, and prevents those plants from regenerating when further damage is inflicted on them.

The Great Hall

This large dining room features a decor that seems almost jarringly out-of-place for the rest of the palace, full of rugged oak beams and stuffed trophies like a rustic hunting lodge. There is a large U-shaped wooden table that fills most of the room, with seats for 19 guests.

Suspended from the rafters is a small gnomish girl, tied up by her own hair. Surrounding her are nine redcap goblins, each stabbing at her lightly with spears.

If the party attempts to intervene, the first attack that successfully hits a goblin will pierce the glamour, revealing all nine goblins and the gnome to be an illusion. In their place will be a large octopus-like creature, which immediately squirts a jet of pure darkness that fills a 5-pace diameter sphere, then vanishes.

Once Decapus has been encountered, it will continue to "stalk" and harass the party for sport, reading their thoughts and using the information gleaned to choose new illusions to fool them. Decapus is intelligent and has a wicked sense of humor; you should use this opportunity to play whatever head-games you can think of, within the boundaries of what your players will consider "good sport".

Decapus (L6 Fey Monster)

Decapus is a mimic, a strange kind of air-breathing cephalopod which can adjust its coloration and shape to match nearly any small or medium object. Normally, a mimic in a dungeon will often transform itself into the appearance of a valuable treasure, in order to lure unwary adventurers close. Once its prey is close enough, it lashes out with six long, rope-like tentacles to try to draw the victim towards its beak. The mimic that haunts the palace is known as "Decapus"; it is unusually intelligent for its species, probably due to the strange fey magics unleashed by the Croidhe mo Mhaistir. Whatever the reason, Decapus has learned how to cast fey illusions.

Decapus often uses its powers to produce illusions of scenes or images it has seen before. For some reason, one of its favorite illusions is that of a young gnome woman tied up by her own exceptionally long hair and harassed by nine redcaps.

Harvesting - If properly harvested, a mimic yields 3d6 charges of psychic materia.

Con +0 (9+)	Str -1 (10+)	Dex +3 (6+)
Int +1 (8+)	Wis +0 (9+)	Cha -2 (11+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Small	
Armor: 0	HP: 3d6	
Attacks (10+): grapple (reach 2), bite (2d6 piercing)		
Skills (3+): Agility, Finesse, Stealth		
Magic: Decapus has 6 glamour, which it can use to cast the beguile, fey illusion, or mirage glammers, or the invisibility, darkness, or read thoughts spells.		

Crushing Hug - A mimic's tentacles begin squeezing once they grapple a target, dealing 1d6 bashing damage per round. Biting any target that it has already grappled is easier.

Poison Bite - Any creature bitten by a mimic is poisoned, reducing the victim's initiative by 1d6 per round until they make a successful save vs. poison.

Camouflage - Detecting a camouflaged mimic is a hard Alertness check; detecting Decapus while it is actively hidden within a fey illusion is impossible for anyone without the Hunter's Expertise feat. Mimics prefer to attack from ambush with their grappling tentacles; a hidden mimic attacks with the Backstab feat. Any attack from ambush hobbles its target whenever any damage die rolls a '6' or better.

Washroom

Behind the great hall is a washroom, with a similar rustic decor. There are bars of soap, towels, and running water; if Decapus enters this room, it will most likely disguise itself as a pile of bath towels.

Lounge

The room directly south of the great hall was a lounge, but all of the furniture has been smashed by a large, enraged bugbear. When the party opens the door, the bugbear will yell "STOP MAKING FUN OF ME!" and charge the party, swinging. It will intersperse its attacks with "IT'S NOT FUNNY ANYMORE, DECAPUS!" and "I WANT TO GO HOME!"

(The bugbear has spent the past few nights being harassed non-stop by Decapus, and can't get a moment's rest. Everything it has tried to eat, drink, sit on, or wield as a weapon has turned out to be Decapus in disguise, and the bugbear is now absolutely paranoid and completely obsessed with finding and killing its tormenter. Nothing the party does or says will convince the bugbear that they aren't just another illusion created by the mimic to mess with its tiny mind. This bugbear used to be part of the small tribe that inhabits the chapel, but Decapus has so thoroughly bullied it that it is convinced that its once-friends are also actually Decapus in disguise, so they kicked him out and abandoned him to wander the halls alone.)

Drawing Room

The next room is empty except for a large woven rug, chairs and tapestries along the walls, and an immense sleeping bear laying in the middle of the rug, with an iron collar locked around its neck. The party must each pass a Stealth check to sneak past the bear, or it will wake up and attack.

Cathbad's Chambers

The next room has been claimed by Cathbad. It is a reasonably well-kept bedchamber, and gives all the appearances of "civilized" living. Cathbad is usually here, studying translations of ancient manuscripts or trying to find a way to unlock the secrets of the ruby-bladed sword that was found in Aine's possession. If he can, he will present himself as a kindly old priest, who is trying to find a way to break the "curse" that has turned Aine into a bear.

Cathbad will usually be accompanied by two bugbear guards, which come from the same "tribe" as the three goblins from the chapel and the poor wretch from the lounge. He will switch up which two goblins are serving as his lackeys from week to week, letting the others "take a break and blow off steam".

Aine (L4 Champion)

Con +1 (10+)	Str +1 (10+)	Dex +0 (11+)
Int +0 (11+)	Wis +2 (9+)	Cha +1 (10+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium	
Armor: 2 / 1 (hide)	HP: 4d6+12	
Attacks (10+): +4 keen longsword (2d6+8)		
Skills (4+): Alertness, Survival, Charm		
Feats: Bear Frenzy x2, can transform into a bear at-will		

Bear Form

Con +4 (7+)	Str +4 (7+)	Dex +0 (11+)
Int +0 (11+)	Wis +2 (11+)	Cha +1 (10+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium	
Armor: 2	HP: 4d6+24	
Attacks (7+): claws (3d6), grapple (3d6+4 blunt)		
Skills (4+): Alertness, Survival, Charm		

Cathbad (L5 Warlock)

Con +0 (10+)	Str +0 (10+)	Dex +0 (10+)
Int +1 (9+)	Wis +2 (8+)	Cha +2 (8+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium	
Armor: 3 / 2 (mithril chainmail)	HP: 5d6	
Attacks (10+): quarterstaff (d6 blunt)		
Skills (3+): Lore, Intuition, Survival, Bearing, Wit		
Magic: 3 faith (Death domain)		

Bugbear Champion (4 HD)

Con +3 (8+)	Str +3 (8+)	Dex +1 (10+)
Int -2 (13+)	Wis +0 (11+)	Cha +0 (11+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Large	
Armor: 2 / 0 (hide)	HP: (4d6+20)x2	
Attacks (8+): oversized greatsword (3d6+3)		
Feats: Panther Frenzy x2, Evasion		
Skills (4+): Stealth, Alertness, Survival		

The Palace Bath

This ornate bathroom has a faucet that can supply hot and cold running water. It has also been enchanted with healing magic; if filled with hot water from the faucet, anyone who soaks in the tub rolls and regains one hit die worth of hit points per exploration round.

Hearthroom

This is a private chamber for the lord or lady of the palace to entertain guests or discuss matters of state; it holds three tables with chairs and a wide, warm fireplace.

Palace Bedroom

This was the palacial bedroom for the lord or lady of the palace; its last occupant was Dame Kyteler. The room is quite well-decorated, and contains various books of lore about the Isle of Mists and druidic practices, annotated by her and Lady d'Meath. Anyone following these notes will not initiate as a druid, but instead become Nature-domain warlocks.

Hallway to the Throneroom

The hallway to the throneroom is completely overgrown with bloodrose vines, which are animated. They writhe and lash, seeking to grab and drain the blood from anything alive. When anyone first turns the corner, the vines will immediately fill the north-south corridor of the hallway for 5 paces, forcing everyone in that space to save vs. blast or suffer 2d6 piercing damage and be grappled and restrained.

Luckily, their motion casts strange moving shadows across the wall before the hallway bends, allowing the party time to prepare themselves. If the party is prepared before turning the corner, their saves become easy, and those who fail their save vs. blast get a second save vs. knockdown to avoid being grappled by the vines.

Aleroom

At the end of the hallway, past the grand entrance to the throneroom, is a small aleroom where guards were stationed and where visitors could wait for an audience with the lord of the keep. It is nearly impossible to enter, as the thorns from the throneroom choke out the hallway.

Throneroom

The scene in the throneroom is beautiful and horrifying all at once.

Suspended above the throne is the body of Dame Alice Kyteler, her ribcage torn open and the Croidhe mo Mhaistir sitting in her chest where her heart should be. The gem emits a brilliant red light that pulses with what would be her heartbeat, if only she still had a heart.

Instead of veins, thorny rosevines snake around the gem and pierce her flesh, before winding around her limbs and spreading out across the throneroom. The roses here are in full bloom, and emit a heady and soporific fragrance that dulls the senses; everyone but Dame Kyteler finds all their rolls harder while in the throneroom. She is wearing a gold locket around her neck; if someone in the party is wearing the corresponding silver locket from the spa room, that character will find that they are also immune to the roses' stupor. However, while in Dame Kyteler's presence, they automatically obey any order that she gives without question.

Dame Alice Kyteler

(5hd Warlock)

Con	-2	(12+)	Str	-1	(11+)	Dex	+1	(9+)
Int	+1	(9+)	Wis	+2	(8+)	Cha	+2	(8+)

Movement:

Slow

Size:

Medium

Armor:

10 (aetheric shield)

HP:

5d6-10

Attacks (11+):

lashing vine whip (2d6-1 piercing, 20 pace reach)

Skills (3+):

Finesse, Lore, Intuition, Survival, Bearing, Charm

Magic:

3 faith. As a Nature priest, Dame Kyteler can perform common miracles, and can prepare elemental glamours. While in posession of the Croidhe mo Mhaistir, Dame Kyteler and has effectively unlimited power, and can attempt to perform any spell, miracle, or glamour at-will.

Shaping a magic with the dragon pearl is a d6 check; first-circle effects happen correctly on a roll of 3-6, while second-circle effects happen correctly on a roll of 4-6, and any third-circle effect is correctly cast on a roll of 5-6. On a failure, the magic is twisted following the rules for the Misty Moor on pg. 6.

Timeline of Disaster

If the party finds Dame Kyteler's diary, they can read this entire timeline in her own words; otherwise, this chapter serves as background notes for the referee.

Dame Kyteler and Lady Petronella d'Meath self-initiated into an eclectic form of worship that they believe to be "authentic druidism", but has been corrupted by various infernal notions into something more akin to warlock priesthood. They used blood sacrifice and various ancient Pictish rites to call on an ancient power, the great wyrm Lig na Paiste, and convince it that they were part of an ancient pagan bloodline ready to reclaim the Isle and banish the Albions and their Church.

Lig na Paiste arrived at roughly the same time that the plague struck the county, in the guise of a silver knight riding on a silver dragon, and gifted Dame Kyteler the ancient artifact called Croidhe mo Mhaistir. In the following days, Dame Kyteler discovered that the silver knight was actually a disguise, and that Lig na Paiste was in fact the dragon itself, although he could take the form of the knight for the sake of diplomacy or romance.

She slowly fell in love with the knight's mortal guise, who she introduced to subjects as "Sir Robin Artisson"; many of the diary's entries describe lurid trysts between herself, the Lady d'Meath, and the "brave, brave Sir Robin". The diary also describes Lady Petronella weaving a "bond of life" between the two of them and the land itself, restoring both of their youth and beauty, and tying their health and vitality to that of the county for as long as they laid claim to rule over it.

In the following months, Dame Kyteler tried in vain to master the artifact's magic. Her experiments first cursed the Misty Moor, then the Stormpeaks, before she finally learned to focus its power through blood and pain. She wove a glamour into the entire span of the county, which allowed her to exert her will through every living plant whose roots grew from the county's soil.

The diary ends here, but what happened next was depressingly predictable: the bloodroses grew beyond her ability to control them, and merged with her and the artifact to create the fey abomination that now inhabits the throne room of the palace.

The tone and contents of Dame Kyteler's diary paint a portrait of victims more than a villains; two women in far over their heads, reaching for powers far beyond their understanding in a time of genuine need and hardship, before being tragically overwhelmed and corrupted by those same powers.

A Quick Note to the Referee

All of the following information should be revealed as the party researches the situation. Everything here is presented for backstory; what happens once the party arrives is entirely up to them. There is no default expected "happy ending" to this tale; if the players manage to resolve the situation, they might do so in a way that makes friends or enemies, and the palace might become a new base of operation for them or be left a smoking ruin in their wake.

Try not to "railroad" the players into a particular outcome. The characters and locales placed here can provide a good basis for an ongoing campaign, if you can make them come alive in the players' minds. Even if the players manage to defeat or rescue Dame Kyteler, befriend or banish the Silver Knight, and restore order to the surrounding countryside, there will still be plenty of work to do for a proper band of intrepid heroes.

Dame Alice Kyteler's Story

Dame Alice Kyteler and her friend, the Lady Patricella d'Meath, hatched a plan to defend the county between the Barrow and Nore rivers from the chaos of the Great Plague.

They used ancient druidic magic to summon a creature of myth and legend - the great wyrm Lig na Paiste - and then asked it to grant them the power to rule, a request which it was bound by oath to fulfill. Unfortunately, that oath was to a fey bloodline descended from one of the great Tuatha de Danaan; through no fault of their own, neither of them exactly fit the bill.

Lady Patricella d'Meath's Story

The resulting chaos left Dame Kyteler trapped within the tangled thorns of the bloodrose vines she summoned, while d'Meath went on to rule the county from Gill-Chainigh. Dame Kyteler feels that she has been betrayed, and is constantly sending goblin raiding parties to capture or kill d'Meath, but thus far d'Meath's own beastfolk guards have managed to protect her - and the attacks let d'Meath claim that she is a necessary and just ruler who is merely trying to "keep the peace" under constant goblin invasion.

Rowena's Story

Rowena remembers when the plague first began to strike the region. The peasants were affected first, followed quickly by the keep's lord and guards. Dame Kyteler and her associate, the Lady Petronella d'Meath, brought in a "champion" who they claimed could help protect the survivors from the plague.

This champion was the Silver Knight, an elven noble named Robin Artson. He arrived riding a silver dragon, and declared that Dame Kyteler was now the Princess in Silver and Crimson, who would restore the ancient pagan pacts between mortals and the fair folk that had been sundered when the Chuch came to the Misty Isles. As a token of his love and loyalty, he offered her Croidhe mo Mhaistir, an unfathomably powerful dragon pearl of pure crimson ruby.

The Silver Knight began tutoring Dame Kyteler in the most powerful magics of Faerie and Dragonkind, teaching her to ward the land against the creeping tendrils of Shadow that followed the plague. Victims of the disease sometimes even survived, and those who died were offered up in sacrificial bonfires to the pagan fey who protected the land.

For a time, all was well. Rowena became Dame Kyteler's bard, entertaining her and the Silver Knight each evening for many years. She barely noticed at first that she had stopped aging. As children began to be born with the telltale signs of the fey, the locals began to wonder what kind of bargain they had struck; but even a few odd-shaped ears and tails here and there weren't enough to worry them.

Only after the victims of the plague began rising as mindless undead, did the Dame Kyteler and her coven begin to worry that they didn't have the power to stop the epidemic. Burned skeletons rose up with fierce red flames in their eyes, and those who had not yet been offered up to the fire rose as shamblers so quickly that their loved ones scarcely noticed they had succumbed.

Dame Kyteler was desperate. Though her Knight begged her not to, she reached deep into Faerie for a glamour that could fight the rising tide, and Faerie answered. Blood-red thorny bushes sprouted from every patch of bare earth, covering every inch of farmland and field with choking vines and fragrant rosebuds. Elves in the Silver Knight's entourage appeared and ferried Rowena deeper into Faerie, and she never set foot back into the Material.

Aine and Mairead's Story

Aine doesn't remember much about her childhood; she only remembers fleeing her village when it was overrun by plague-shamblers, with her baby brother and sister in her arms, and a glowing red sword at her hip. Some kind of fey curse overtook them, and transformed them all into enormous white bears; it was only the kindness of Cathbad that saved them, when he took them in and began trying to undo the curse.

In truth, Cathbad has been manipulating Aine the whole time, using her as his bodyguard and enforcer while telling her that he is looking for a cure to her "condition". She and her brother and sister are all bear puccas, and are perfectly capable of learning how to control their shapeshifting abilities; Cathbad uses various beguiling curses to convince them that they become violent, bloodthirsty beasts while transformed, and only their iron collars keep them safe.

Cathbad recently decided that Aine's bonds to her brother and sister were interfering with his influence over her, so he sold them to the tribe of redcaps that infest the lower levels of the palace, while telling Aine that they are there to 'train' alongside the goblins; Aine only believes this because she believes the redcaps to be the children of the bugbears that accompanied her and Cathbad into the palace. When she finds out that the redcaps have eaten her little brother, she will likely go on a bloody rampage, tearing Cathbad, the bugbears, and all the redcaps to shreds in her rage and grief.

Aine was the "maiden fair" that the Silver Knight was originally looking for when he came to Kilkenny, but Dame Kyteler used fey glamour to trick him into thinking she was his fated queen instead. Once he understands the deception, the devastation wrought by Dame Kyteler's magics will finally make sense to him, and his vengeance will be swift and brutal.

Aine is, at this point, not psychologically suited for the kind of responsibilities that ruling Kilkenny would entail. An Intuition check (which will be easy for a Priest, or normal difficulty for anyone else) will uncover this if the party chooses to engage with Aine at length about what she's endured and how she feels about all the hardships she's endured. Her little sister will be a much better candidate once she comes of age; Aine would be much happier acting as her sister's protector than trying to rule an entire county herself.

The Silver Knight's Story

The Silver Knight is Lig na Paiste, an ancient celestial dragon, who has tried from time to time to tame the Misty Isle's wild fey energies. So far, he has failed at each attempt.

He has a fey pact with a fair folk Numen that has protected the isle for millenia; part of the terms of this pact require that he work his efforts alongside her direct female descendants. When Dame Alice Kyteler summoned him, she convinced him that she was one of those descendents, calling on him to fulfill his ancient oath; all of the chaos that has ensued since is the direct result of that deception.

The Silver Knight is not a particularly Good or Bad being, from the Church's perspective; he is much more a primal force of nature, like all of the fey influences within the Isle of Mists. It was he who originally forged Croidhe mo Mhaistir, and the twin blades named Claiomh Solais; when used in tandem, the blades can open a portal to his home nest within the Elemental Chaos, where they (and his own dragon pearl) were first forged.

Lig na Paiste normally inhabits the far northern shores of the Isle of Mists; before being summoned by Dame Kyteler, he had not been this far south in ten thousand years. As such, he is quite unfamiliar with local geography and customs. If the Croidhe mo Mhaistir is somehow destroyed, Lig na Paiste will be banished back to the northern lake he once called home. Otherwise, he might become an ally or an adversary, based on the party's goals and how they act towards him.

The Chaplain's Story

The chaplain of the palace was worried for the souls of Dame Alice and Lady Patricella; he was murdered for his troubles by his pupil Cathbad, who burned him alive in a sacrificial rite to Crom Cruach that summoned the goblin army from faerie that Dame Alice and Lady d'Meath now struggle to command.

Since his murder, he has been forced to watch from Shadow as Cathbad counceiled Dame Kyteler into using the Croidhe mo Mhaistir in more and more inadvisable ways, culminating in her transformation into the monstrosity in the throne room. He watched as Cathbad counceiled Patricella d'Meath to flee the palace and take up residence in Cill-Chainnigh, and to send any "troublemakers" to the palace for him to deal with. He watched as Cathbad picked from among those sent to the castle by Lady d'Meath, selling those that failed to interest him to the redcaps and keeping those who showed any potential of being genuine heirs to the Croidhe mo Mhaistir's power. And he watched as Cathbad tricked and enslaved Aine and her siblings, then sold her brother and sister to the redcaps when her love for them threatened his control over her.

The chaplain has a lot to be angry about.

Claiomh Solais, the Ruby Blade

Aine barely remembers anything of her early childhood before becoming a bear pucca, but she remembers that her mother gave her a thin, elegantly crafted fey longsword with a blade seeminly carved from a single bright crimson ruby. The blade is a legendary primal aetheric blade, and is a "matched pair" with the silver blade from the bathhouse - which is confusingly also called "Claiomh Solais" in manuscripts. Unlike most aetheric blades, this weapon can cut a path directly into the elemental chaos - but only when slicing open a rift into faerie already made by its silver "brother". If both blades are used in this fashion, one after the other, the portal opens to a basalt altar in the middle of a sea of lava, with an anvil atop the altar which can be used by 9th-level magic-users to craft legendary magic items after sufficient study. (Learning how to do this is certainly going to be an adventure all of its own; it's best if this is kept as a "story hook" for future adventures, once the party is experienced enough to start experimenting.)

Studying Cathbad's notes will reveal that the blade is actually a legendary primal artifact called Claiomh Solais, and it was crafted as part of a set from a single, vast crystal of "dragon pearl" along with Croidhe mo Mhaistir. As such, both artifacts remain "in resonance" with each other, and glamours, spells or miracles that target one will also affect the other.

Cathbad wants to use this resonance to gain control of Dame Kyteler, and therefore the bloodrose infestation - and then use that power to wrest control of the region from Lady d'Meath. Unfortunately, the sword's powers only work for the direct matrilineal descendents of an ancient druidess; Aine and Mairead happen to be her last great-great-great-great-great-(great?)-granddaughters. If Aine or Mairead can be convinced to help the party, they might allow any of the party's magic-users to channel and amplify their magics through the sword while they wield it, quickly solving everyone's problems.

According to Cathbad's notes, the white blade also has a corresponding "heart", which currently serves as a genuine "dragon pearl" set into the forehead of the celestial dragon that taught Dame Kyteler how to use the ruby. The notes also indicate that the "Silver Knight" was actually an illusion or polymorph-form of the dragon itself, who was Dame Kyteler's actual lover. The notes further speculate that the failure of the ruby's magic was due to Dame Kyteler not actually being of the proper bloodline to control the ruby, and that either Aine or Mairead might be able to wrest control and repair the damage wrought by Kyteler's miscast glamours. This would only be possible, he muses, by a properly-trained druid; his diary suggests that he plans to go below and buy Mairead off of the redcaps tomorrow, as he deems Aine too old and "set in her ways" to begin proper druidic initiation.

olutions

There are several ways that the party could undo Dame Kyteler's curse.

The most straightforward approach won't work; trying to cut or burn the thorns out of Dame Kyteler's heart, or trying to destroy her body or the roses, will simply reduce them to ash, after which they will regenerate as if the reincarnation primal ritual was performed. The Croidhe mo Mhaistir will ensure that the new body is still that of Dame Kyteler, but each time she regenerates she becomes less and less human, and more and more a thing of twisting thorns and vines.

Destroying the Croidhe mo Mhaistir

If the Croidhe mo Mhaistir is pierced by both blades, it will shatter, and the resonance will also destroy the red Claiomh Solais. This will free Lig na Paiste completely from his oath, which will also cut him off from any further ability to enter or affect the material plane - in effect, he will be banished into the Faerie echoes of a small lake along the isle's northern shores, where he will strive in vain to escape his prison until the end of time.

Attuning to an Heir

The Croidhe mo Mhaistir could instead be de-attuned from Dame Kyteler, and attuned to either Aine or Mairead. Properly attuning the gem requires that the druidess cut her hand with the red Claiomh Solais, then place her bloody palm on the surface of the stone.

Dame Kyteler will fight to the death to stop this process, because a successful atunement will cause her and all the bloodroses to immediately wither to dust. If Aine succeeds at this, the Silver Knight will appear and pledge his service to her, declare that she is the ruler of the land, and ask for her bidding.

If Mairead attunes to the stone instead, the Silver Knight will recognize that she is a child, and will offer to act as her steward and tutor until such time as she feels she is prepared to rule. As steward, Lig na Paiste is surprisingly sensible and fair, and is willing to discuss the notion of becoming a guardian Numen with the party's priest if the matter is broached respectfully.

Rescuing Dame Kyteler

It might be possible to attune to the stone without killing Dame Kyteler, if the Silver Knight can be convinced that she deserves to be saved. Dame Kyteler herself must also be convinced to willingly give up the stone to Aine or Mairead, and genuinely atone for the harm she has wrought on the county.

If guided to atonement by a priest before she gives up the gem, she might be able to use its last vestiges of power to repair the damage the bloodroses have done to her body. She will be in critical condition and will require months of bedrest, but she will survive. Such a feat should not be handled lightly; genuine atonement for the desecration of miles of land and the deaths of thousands of mortals is no easy feat. An atoned Dame Kyteler might choose to become a nun in the chapel, or might leave the Isle of Mists altogether.

Restoring the County

Once the curse has been lifted, the county will still show signs of supernatural scarring. The mortal inhabitants will still continue to give birth to beastfolk children far more often than normal, and the landscape will continue to be a dreamlike blend of Faerie and the Material.

Usurping the Lady Petronella d'Meath will be easy, if the Croidhe mo Mhaistir and Lig na Paiste remain in the county. If the party solves the problem by shattering the gem, she will be handled by local authorities - most likely inquisitors sent from the Church via Albion, who will try and convict her for witchcraft and heresy as soon as a new lord takes control of the keep. As harsh as this is, it is much kinder than what the Silver Knight would have in store for her, if his wrath goes untempered by Mairead's counsel.

Now What?

From here, the party might choose to use Kilkenny County as their base of operations, or they might return to the Pale Keep; they might also be offered a chance to join the Albion-Francia war on the Europa mainland, if the crown receives word of their deeds and they have made a sufficiently heroic showing.

As vassals of Contessa Aine or Contessa Mairead, the party might spend their time clearing out the Stormpeaks, the Misty Moor, and the Feywoods of any lingering dangers; once the wilds have been tamed, they will find Kilkenny to be a sensible little county.

The Croidhe mo Mhaistir is an absurdly powerful artifact, but also wild and untamed. Even in the hands of a proper heir, its magic will often cause as much trouble as it solves.

If Aine is contessa of Kilkenny, she will never let on that there is a problem; instead, she will simply become more and more frustrated by her inability to control the artifact's power, until a new disaster strikes. Talking her down from this will be a difficult balancing act for even the most level-headed party of advisors; eventually, only her sister will be able to truly talk sense into her. (This will eventually lead to Aine abdicating her title, and ordering her sister Mairead to rule in her stead.

Mairead will prove to be a much smarter and more capable ruler, who will take a good deal of interest in the well-being of her people, and especially in using technology to improve it. She will pay large sums from the treasury to entice human and dwarven engineers from Albion and Aeterna into her court, and will eagerly try all sorts of schemes to harness the gem's power for good.

Ultimately, the safest use for the gem will turn out to be the tried-and-true military solution: as a legendary dragon pearl, the gem is quite well-suited for powering a golem armor the likes of which have not been seen since the fall of the Old Empire, or possibly even the days of Azlanteos. With a functioning golem armor to protect her county, Mairead will declare her land free from the Albion crown, and be free to govern it as she sees fit.

Lady Patricella d'Meath (L6 Druid)

Con -1 (10+)	Str +0 (9+)	Dex +1 (8+)
Int +0 (9+)	Wis +1 (8+)	Cha +1 (8+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium	
Armor: 1 (jack vest)	HP: 6d6-6	
Attacks (13+): +1 longsword (d6+1)		
Skills (3+): Stealth, Lore, Intuition, Survival, Bearing		

Beastfolk Captains (L3 Champion) x 5

Con +1 (11+)	Str +1 (11+)	Dex +1 (11+)
Int -1 (13+)	Wis +0 (12+)	Cha -1 (13+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium	
Armor: 2 / 0 (hide) + shield	HP: 3d6+3	
Attacks (11+): spear (d6+1)		
Feats: Boar Frenzy x2, can transform into a boar at-will		

Beastfolk Guards (L2 Champion) x 25

Con +1 (12+)	Str +1 (12+)	Dex +1 (12+)
Int -1 (14+)	Wis +0 (13+)	Cha -1 (14+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium	
Armor: 2 / 1 (hide) + shield	HP: 2d6+2	
Attacks (12+): spear (d6+1)		
Feats: Boar Frenzy x1, can transform into a boar at-will		

Beastfolk Archers (L2 Hunter) x 10

Con +1 (12+)	Str +1 (12+)	Dex +1 (12+)
Int -1 (14+)	Wis +0 (13+)	Cha -1 (14+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium	
Armor: 2 / 1 (hide) + shield	HP: 2d6+2	
Attacks (12+): spear (d6+1)		
Skills (4+): Stealth, Alertness, Survival		
Feats: Backstab, can transform into a boar at-will		

Tinker Gabhan (L5 Dweomersmith)

Con +1 (9+)	Str +1 (9+)	Dex +0 (10+)
Int +1 (9+)	Wis +0 (10+)	Cha +2 (8+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Medium	
Armor: 3 / 2 (chainmail +1)	HP: 5d6+10	
Attacks (9+): Thundering warhammer (3d6+1 blunt)		
Skills (3+): Finesse, Science, Charm, Wit		
Magic: Gabhan can prepare and maintain up to two common and one uncommon dweomers.		

Goodwitch Fiona (L3 Druid)

Con +0 (12+)	Str +0 (12+)	Dex +1 (11+)
Int +0 (12+)	Wis +1 (11+)	Cha +3 (9+)
Movement: 5 paces	Size: Small	
Armor: 1 (jack vest)	HP: 3d6	
Attacks (12+): quarterstaff (d6 blunt)		
Skills (4+): Medicine, Intuition, Survival, Bearing, Charm, Wit		
Magic: 3 glamour; Fiona has also befriended a wood wisp and a flame wisp.		

